

# Digital Business Models

## Compleasy



Chair of Information Systems and Electronic Services

Business Plan

Group 1



TECHNISCHE  
UNIVERSITÄT  
DARMSTADT

**ISE**

Information Systems  
and Electronic Services

Technische Universität Darmstadt

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As a requirement of Digital Business Model

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**Formal Declaration**

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**Thesis Statement pursuant to § 22 paragraph 7 of APB TU Darmstadt**

I herewith formally declare that I, *Kamran Ali, Rizuanul Kabir, Lorenz Wenzel, Qiao Ren, Beschta Sidiq, Marc Wirthmann, Anas El Baghdadi, Johannes Mann, and Hakim Adams Yakubu*, have written the submitted thesis independently pursuant to § 22 paragraph 7 of APB TU Darmstadt without any outside support and using only the quoted literature and other sources. I did not use any outside support except for the quoted literature and other sources mentioned in the paper. I have clearly marked and separately listed in the text the literature used literally or in terms of content and all other sources I used for the preparation of this academic work. This also applies to sources or aids from the Internet.

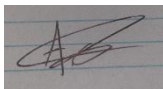
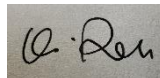
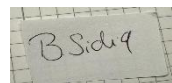
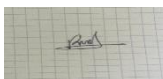
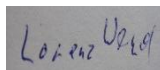
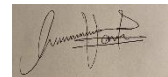
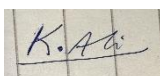
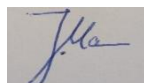
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## 1. Executive Summary

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Compleasy is a solution helping German small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) to fulfil compliance laws like the LkSG and the European CSDDD. Our mission is to turn compliance from manual work into automated and audit-ready results.

German SMEs are facing a compliance gap. Around 45,000 companies are affected by supply chain regulations - either by law or by their enterprise customers. However, they lack suitable tools. Enterprise solutions are too expensive and complex and manual workflows relying on legacy tools are inefficient and risky.

To solve this, we offer a cloud-based AI platform. Compleasy ingests unstructured supplier data and analyzes it to offer structured information. The platform offers automated risk scoring and one-click creation of BAFA-compliant audit reports. We ensure data sovereignty through full hosting in Germany to meet GDPR compliance and build trust.

We expect a Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) of 3,150 SMEs generating €9.4M in annual revenue by 2032. Our go-to-market strategy is phased beginning with a validation phase in 2026 with customers in the textile sector. This is followed by a move in 2027 to a Partner-Led Model to drive further growth.

Compleasy is led by a team of nine co-founders who cover legal and technical expertise. The team has legal knowledge by our CSO, AI expertise by our CTO and Chief AI Officer and B2B commercials driven by the CEO and CGO.

To fast-track our product development, an MVP is defined and created that focuses on the most important functionalities and features required by our customers. It will contain a central dashboard that highlights the easiness of our platform. Next, a central supplier management and geographical display will tackle the challenge of data maintenance. An AI powered document scanner and automatic report generation will close the loop showing the ultimate benefit of using an integrated platform like Compleasy.

We aim for a capital-efficient financial model. Compleasy requires €290,000 in total external funding (Pre-Seed) to reach a sustainable level. We see EBITDA breakeven by Year 3 (2028), with revenue forecasted to grow from €176k in Year 1 to €9.4M in Year 7. By 2032, we expect €10.1M in cumulative earnings with no debt.

Compleasy is not just a tool. It is the central infrastructure for a modern supply chain, enabling German SMEs to focus on their business while AI handles the hard work for them.

Note: All info. In executive summary is sourced from further sections where original sources have been provided

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## 2. Company goals

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At Compleasy, we envision redefining how the European "Mittelstand" approaches the growing number of global supply chain regulations (*IHK-Umfrage, 2025*). We believe compliance shouldn't hinder international trade or cause administrative paralysis. Rather, it should be streamlined, automated, and offer a strategic advantage. Our mission is to provide small- and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) with an AI-driven, cloud-based command center that transforms the regulatory of laws such as the German Supply Chain Due Diligence Act (LkSG) and the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD) into a manageable, audit-ready process. By bridging the gap between chaotic, manual Excel processes and overly complex enterprise software, we aim to become the leading compliance partner for SMEs across Germany and Europe.

### i) Short-Term Goals (Year 1: Market Entry and Validation)

Our primary objective for the first twelve months is to successfully enter the market and validate our core value proposition. We have identified a significant market gap: existing tools are either too expensive or lack the necessary AI capabilities to interpret complex legal documents. Within the first three months, we aim to acquire three to five early adopters, specifically targeting textile SMEs with significant documentation issues from sourcing in regions such as Bangladesh or Vietnam. This "proof of concept (POC) phase" is critical to refining our document ingestion, risk scoring logic, and reporting output based on real-world data.

We intend to test and finalize our flat subscription model to ensure it remains affordable for the Mittelstand while maintaining healthy margins. Our goal is to demonstrate that SMEs are willing to pay for a solution that provides "automated document intelligence" at a significantly lower price point than traditional enterprise suites like SAP GRC. Compliance is built on trust. A key goal for the first year is to establish our first "lighthouse customers" and secure legal certifications, such as ISO or SOC2, to demonstrate our dedication to storing data on German servers and complying with the GDPR. We will assemble an effective yet lean team of 11 specialists, including our founding team and initial software engineers, to ensure platform stability and rapid feature development.

### ii) Mid-Term Goals (Years 2-3: Scaling and Ecosystem Building)

After our core workflows have been validated, we will shift our focus from direct acquisition to scalable growth and ecosystem integration. Our goal is to capture a significant portion of our serviceable obtainable market (SOM), which we estimate to be 3,150 affected SMEs in Germany (*IHK-Umfrage, 2025*).

By the end of Year 3, we aim to have a customer base of around 100 clients and generate nearly €800,000 in forecasted revenues. In order to lower our customer acquisition cost (CAC) and scale efficiently, we will build a robust partner network. This includes system integrators, consultants, and law firms that will act as resellers or referral partners. We will offer attractive reseller margins of 20-25% and "Premium Partner" benefits to ensure that Compleasy is the top recommendation for compliance advisors.

We plan to transition from "Active Intelligence" (document scanning and scoring) to "Continuous Compliance." This includes enhancing our "Intelligent Chatbot" to handle more complex, ad hoc queries and providing deeper legal traceability to satisfy government regulators and "whale" customers, such as large enterprises like BMW or Bosch, who demand risk analysis from their SME suppliers. Although the initial years require substantial investment in AI architecture and personnel, our objective is to gradually enhance our EBITDA margin, approaching break-even as we leverage the low marginal costs of our SaaS model.

### **iii) Long-Term Strategic Positioning**

Compleasy's goal is to occupy the "High AI Depth + High Legal Traceability" quadrant of the market. Our long-term goal is to be more than just a tool. We aspire to be the "trust infrastructure" for global supply chains. As regulations evolve, Compleasy will adapt, ensuring that, for companies compliance becomes a simple, automated "plug and play" reality rather than a "wall of worry!" Our goal is to set the standard for Mittelstand-friendly user experience (UX), providing evidence-based, audit-proof insights to every manufacturer, regardless of their IT budget.

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### 3. Product & Services

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Compleasy is designed to be a cloud computing-based supply chain that uses artificial intelligence to optimize operations specifically for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) with globally interconnected supply networks with multiple supplier levels. The platform acts as a centralized command centre that orchestrates supplier documentation, regulatory due diligence, risk assessment, and audit-ready reporting in an end-to-end digital workflow. Compleasy equips businesses to meet evolving compliance standards from initiatives such as Germany's Supply Chain Due Diligence Act and the EU's sustainability directive which impose stringent documentation, monitoring, and reporting obligations on companies and their suppliers.

At its core, Compleasy transforms compliance from a fragmented, manual, and high-risk activity into a continuous, automated, and transparent process. Today, compliance managers often rely on a patchwork of PDFs, spreadsheets, email threads, and static reports. This results in administrative overload, limited transparency, and significant legal exposure, as even a single missing or outdated supplier certificate can lead to fines, reputational damage, or loss of business. Compleasy replaces this "manual chaos" with a unified Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) solution that automates document ingestion, identifies missing information, analyses unstructured content, and produces legally defensible, audit-ready outputs.

The product is delivered entirely via the cloud, eliminating the need for on premise installation or lengthy implementation projects. This approach reflects the realities of SMEs, which typically lack the IT resources or budgets required for enterprise-grade governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) systems. Compleasy enables rapid onboarding, fast integration, and immediate value realization, allowing customers to move from initial setup to operational use in a relatively short period of time.

Compleasy is currently positioned as an ESG and supply chain due diligence assessor, with a strong focus on supplier document intelligence, automated risk scoring, and reporting. The platform already supports core workflows such as automated supplier outreach, AI-driven document analysis using retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) technology, and structured compliance reporting aligned with regulatory requirements. Ongoing development is expanding these capabilities toward continuous compliance monitoring and deeper agentic intelligence.

#### 3.1 Customer Benefits and Value Proposition

Compleasy's value proposition is built around a clear and urgent customer need: enabling SMEs to remain compliant with increasingly complex supply chain regulations without incurring enterprise level costs or administrative burden. The platform delivers both functional and emotional benefits that directly address the day-to-day challenges faced by compliance managers, procurement leaders, and legal teams.

### **3.1.1 Functional Benefits**

#### **Radical Reduction of Manual Workload**

Compleasy automates the most time-consuming aspects of supply chain compliance. Intelligent, agent-based workflows generate supplier emails, reminders, and checklists to collect missing documents, eliminating the need for manual follow-ups. Automated document ingestion and classification allow large volumes of unstructured PDFs to be processed instantly, freeing skilled employees from low-value administrative tasks.

#### **Improved Legal Certainty and Risk Transparency**

Using large language models, Compleasy analyses supplier documents in depth, assigns standardized risk scores (low, medium, high), and derives actionable recommendations. Unlike traditional tools that rely on static checklists or self-assessments, Compleasy provides paragraph cited insights that ensure traceability and legal defensibility. This significantly reduces the risk of overlooked issues and supports informed decision making.

#### **Audit Reporting**

Compleasy's Easy Report Generation capability assists customers to provide compliant, audit ready reports on demand. Reports are generated directly from analyzed source documents, maintaining a complete end to end audit trail. This shortens preparation time for audits and inspections while increasing confidence in the accuracy and completeness of submitted information.

#### **Fast Deployment and Ease of Use**

As a fully cloud-based SaaS solution, Compleasy requires no local installation and minimal configuration. Customers can start using the platform almost immediately, benefiting from intuitive user interfaces designed for non-technical users. This ease-of-use lowers adoption barriers and accelerates time to value.

#### **Emotional and Strategic Benefits for Decision Makers**

Compliance managers carry personal and organizational liability for regulatory failures. Compleasy reduces this psychological burden by providing continuous visibility into compliance status, clear risk prioritization, and governed outputs validated through legal expertise. Compliance becomes manageable rather than overwhelming.

#### **Compliance as a Competitive Advantage**

Rather than viewing compliance solely as a cost center, Compleasy enables SMEs to position robust supply chain governance as a differentiator. Customers can demonstrate transparency, responsibility, and preparedness to regulators, auditors, and large enterprise clients, strengthening trust and commercial relationships.



## **Affordability and Predictable Costs**

Compleasy offers a flat-rate tiered subscription pricing model tailored to SME budgets, avoiding hidden costs, per-module fees, or long-term implementation expenses. This predictable cost structure stands in contrast to traditional enterprise GRC solutions and makes advanced compliance technology accessible to mid-sized organizations.

### **3.1.2 Value Proposition**

Compleasy occupies a unique strategic position within the industry by integrating:

- High AI-depth with advanced document intelligence and agentic workflows
- High legal traceability through paragraph cited, audit-proof outputs
- SME friendly pricing and deployment models
- German data residency and strict GDPR compliance

No existing competitor currently delivers this combination of deep AI capabilities and legally defensible compliance insights at a cost structure suitable for SMEs.

## **3.2 Product and Services Development**

### **3.2.1 Current Development Stage**

Compleasy is in an advanced product development and early market validation stage. Core functionalities document ingestion and classification, AI-based risk scoring, automated supplier communication, and report generation are operational and being validated with early adopters. Initial proof of concept (POC) customers are being onboarded to test workflows using real supplier data and to refine usability, accuracy, and performance.

### **3.2.2 Product Lifecycle and Future Iterations**

The product roadmap follows a phased lifecycle approach:

#### **Phase 1: Core Compliance Automation (Current)**

Focus on supplier document collection, AI-driven analysis, standardized risk scoring, and audit ready reporting aligned with LkSG and CSDDD requirements.

#### **Phase 2: Continuous Compliance and Monitoring**

Expansion toward continuous monitoring of regulatory changes, supplier updates, and risk signals. Automated alerts and periodic reassessments will ensure compliance remains up to date over time rather than point in time.

### Phase 3: Advanced Agentic Intelligence

In this phase, Compleasy evolves from a compliance tool into a digital compliance assistant. The platform will proactively support users by answering ad-hoc compliance questions, drafting customized reports, and guiding users through complex regulatory scenarios. Intelligent AI agents continuously analyze supplier data and regulations, while a human in the loop approach ensures that all critical outputs remain accurate, governed, and legally reliable. The result is faster decision-making, less manual effort, and greater confidence in compliance outcomes.

#### 3.2.3 Research and Development Strategy

Research and development are a core strategic pillar of Compleasy and underpins the company's technological differentiation and long-term competitiveness. R&D efforts focus on building an AI-powered compliance platform that is scalable, legally defensible, and adaptable to continuously evolving supply chain regulations, while remaining accessible and intuitive for small and medium-sized enterprises.

The main objective of R&D is to automate complex compliance workflows and reduce manual effort without compromising legal accuracy or auditability. This is achieved through continuous enhancement of AI-driven document intelligence, risk assessment logic, and workflow automation. Compleasy invests heavily in improving its ability to analyze large volumes of unstructured supplier documentation, using retrieval augmented generation techniques to ensure that all AI outputs remain grounded in verifiable source passages and are traceable at the paragraph level.

A key R&D focus area is the refinement of proprietary risk scoring models that translate qualitative legal and ESG information into structured, actionable risk signals. These models are designed to be explainable, consistent, and operationally relevant, linking identified risks directly to procedural recommendations and mitigation actions. Ongoing validation against expert legal review ensures that outputs remain reliable and defensible in audit and regulatory contexts.

Compleasy is also advancing agentic AI workflows that automate multi-step compliance processes. These intelligent agents manage supplier communication, identify missing information, respond to ad-hoc compliance queries, and support report drafting, while human-in-the-loop mechanisms ensure control, accountability, and governance. Over time, these capabilities enable a shift from reactive, point-in-time assessments to proactive and continuous compliance.

In parallel, R&D activities focus on modelling regulatory requirements in a structured and machine-readable way. This includes tracking regulatory changes, maintaining version control, and mapping obligations to specific documentation and controls.

Usability and trust are integral components of R&D. Product development emphasizes intuitive user experiences tailored to non-technical users, while system architecture prioritizes data security, GDPR compliance, and German data residency.

Compleasy follows an iterative, feedback-driven R&D process with short development cycles, close collaboration between engineering and legal experts, and continuous input from early customers and partners. This approach enables rapid innovation while maintaining the high standards of legal precision and reliability required in regulated environments.

### **3.3 Production and Delivery**

#### **Service Delivery Model**

Compleasy is delivered as a subscription-based SaaS platform. Customers access the system via secure web interfaces, with no on-premises infrastructure required. Optional add-on services include access to independent legal experts, lawyer networks, and additional advisory services.

#### **Infrastructure and Data Residency**

The platform is hosted exclusively on German cloud infrastructure providers (e.g., StackIT). This ensures full GDPR compliance, high data security standards, and alignment with customer expectations regarding data sovereignty. German data residency is a core trust element, particularly for regulated industries.

#### **Quality Control and Governance**

Quality assurance is embedded throughout the delivery process. AI-generated outputs are governed by predefined compliance logic and, where required, validated through human in the loop review processes. Independent legal experts provide oversight to ensure interpretations and recommendations remain audit-proof and aligned with evolving regulations.

#### **Scalability And Operations**

The cloud-native architecture enables scalable onboarding of customers ranging from small organizations with fewer than 50 suppliers to large SMEs managing thousands of suppliers and documents. Operational scalability is supported by modular infrastructure, predictable subscription pricing, and partner-driven distribution channels.

#### **Supply Chain and Partner Ecosystem**

Rather than relying on physical manufacturing, Compleasy's supply chain consists primarily of technology providers, cloud infrastructure partners, and a growing ecosystem of consultants, auditors, and law firms. Strategic partnerships enable rapid market access, reduced customer acquisition costs, and scalable deployment.

### **3.4 Products and Services Summary**

Compleasy's products and services are purpose-built to address a clear and underserved market need thus an affordable, AI-powered, and legally defensible supply chain compliance for SMEs. Through a combination of advanced document intelligence, agentic automation, and trust-centric design choices, Compleasy demonstrates strong operational viability and market relevance. The

platform is positioned to evolve alongside regulatory requirements, transforming compliance from a reactive obligation into a proactive strategic capability.

#### 4. Market Research and Competitors Gap Analysis

Compleasy aims to provide an AI-powered compliance platform specifically designed for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) with international supply chains. Conducting thorough market research is essential to understand the landscape in which Compleasy will operate. This research focuses on market overview, market size, and the regulatory challenges that SMEs face.

##### 4.1 Market Overview

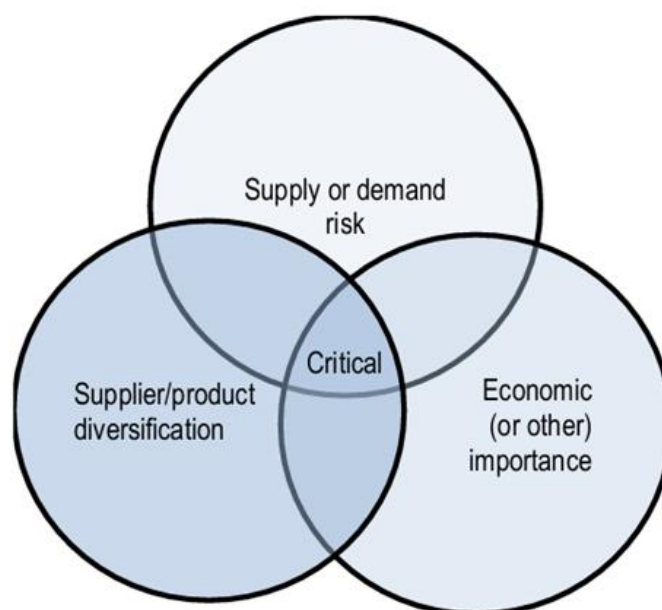


Figure 1 Market Overview Highlight (OECD, 2025)

The market overview highlights three critical areas that intersect and define the operational landscape for Compleasy:

**Supply or Demand Risk:** This aspect refers to the potential threats that SMEs face due to fluctuations in supply chains. In an integrated global marketplace, SMEs are becoming more susceptible to operational breakdowns resulting from international political friction, catastrophic natural events, or financial downturns. The COVID-19 pandemic starkly illustrated these vulnerabilities, emphasizing the need for robust risk management strategies (OECD, 2025).

**Supplier/Product Diversification:** SMEs often struggle with diversifying their suppliers, which is essential to mitigate risks associated with over-reliance on a limited number of sources. Effective supplier diversification can help SMEs reduce their exposure to supply chain disruptions (OECD, 2025). Compleasy's platform aims to facilitate this diversification by providing tools that assist in supplier management and compliance tracking.

**Economic (or Other) Importance:** Compliance with regulations is becoming increasingly critical for SMEs. The economic implications of failing to comply are significant, including legal penalties and loss of market access. Government policies are shifting to ensure economic security, which directly impacts SMEs involved in international supply chains (OECD, 2025).

The intersection of these three areas creates a "critical" space where Compleasy can position its services effectively, helping SMEs navigate the complexities of compliance while managing supply chain risks.

## 4.2 Market Size

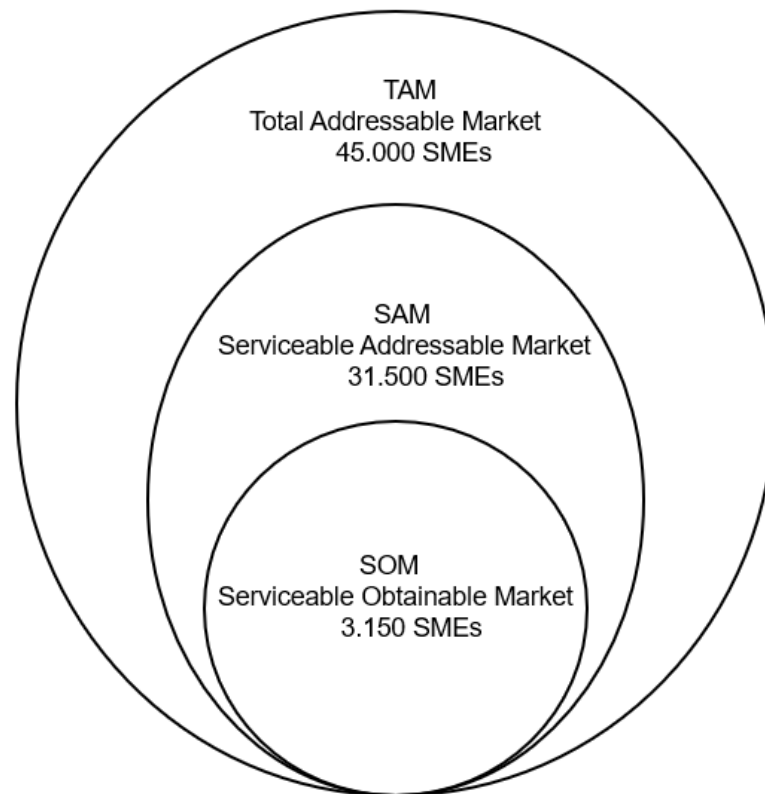


Figure 2 Market Sizing (IHK-Umfrage, 2025)

Understanding the market size is essential for assessing Compleasy's growth potential in Germany. The Total Addressable Market (TAM) is estimated at 45,000 SMEs in Germany. This figure represents all small and medium-sized businesses that could potentially benefit from Compleasy's compliance solutions. Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM): Out of the total SMEs, 31,500 are affected by compliance regulations (*IHK-Umfrage, 2025*), indicating a substantial target for Compleasy. This segment is critical as it reflects the immediate demand for compliance solutions that help SMEs meet regulatory requirements.

Compleasy aims to serve 3,150 SMEs directly (*IHK-Umfrage, 2025*). This figure represents a realistic target for market penetration and emphasizes the need for strategic marketing and outreach efforts to effectively engage this specific group of potential clients. The introduction of the German Supply Chain Due Diligence Act (*Lieferkettensorgfaltspflichtengesetz*) has profound implications for SMEs. Nearly 70% of SMEs are affected by this legislation (*IHK-Umfrage, 2025*). A major concern for SMEs is the bureaucratic overhead associated with compliance. Surveys indicate that 75% of directly affected companies report increased administrative work, while 84% express concerns about the complexity of compliance processes. Additionally, 95% of companies

report high administrative costs and 88% cite rising expenses due to compliance requirements (IHK-Umfrage, 2025).

The law took effect in January 2023 for companies with more than 3,000 employees and was expanded in January 2024 to include companies with more than 1,000 employees (EQS Compliance-Wissen, 2025). While smaller businesses are not directly affected, many SMEs are indirectly impacted because larger companies require their suppliers to comply with certain obligations. The legislation forces SMEs to reassess their supplier relationships. Nearly 50% of SMEs avoid high-risk suppliers, which can reduce supplier diversity and increase dependency on fewer partners (Mittelstand Inside Magazin, 2025). Legal Uncertainty and Competitive Disadvantages: Indirectly affected SMEs face liability risks and declining competitiveness. Only 3% of surveyed companies see no risks (EQS Compliance-Wissen, 2025).

The EU directive initially aimed to impose stricter rules than German law, covering companies with 250 employees and requiring full supply chain due diligence. However, the directive was significantly weakened in late 2025: it now applies only to companies with more than 5,000 employees and €1.5 billion in revenue. It also removes civil liability and eliminates mandatory climate action plans (SPIEGEL Wirtschaft, 2025).

4.3 Competitor Pricing Intelligence

| Competitor    | Pricing Model         | Est. Cost                | Hidden Cost                              |
|---------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| SAP GRC       | License + Maintenance | Not appl. For SMEs       | SAP stack required; no stand alone       |
| Osapiens      | Per User/Module       | Variable (Industry size) | Costs scale up with supplier/ESG modules |
| IntegrityNext | Subscription          | From €10K/Year           | Pricing tied to revenue tiers            |
| CONSUST       | Consulting + SaaS     | €12K-€22K/Year           | Value decreased after 2025 pivot         |
| Compleasy     | Flat Platform Fee     | €3.6K-€45K/Year          | Full Transparency                        |

Table 1 Competitor Analysis

Traditional compliance solutions often come with complex and expensive cost structures. Companies face high license fees, lengthy implementation projects, and additional training costs. Pricing models typically scale with the number of suppliers or modules, and many providers tie costs to revenue tiers. These factors lead to unpredictable expenses and deployment timelines that can stretch from six to twelve months.

Compleasy offers a different approach. Our platform provides predictable flat-rate pricing with full transparency and no hidden costs. Businesses gain access to the latest compliance technologies without the burden of per-supplier or revenue-based scaling. Most importantly, Compleasy ensures fast deployment, allowing SMEs to start using the platform quickly and efficiently.

#### 4.4 Market Context and Analytical Objective

The regulatory landscape for corporate accountability has evolved rapidly, moving from national mandates to supranational directives. Regulations such as the German Supply Chain Due Diligence Act ((Lieferkettensorgfaltspflichtengesetz [LkSG], 2021)), in force since January 1, 2023, required the implementation of preventive measures and the continuous monitoring of supply chain partners to mitigate ecological and humanitarian risks. As noted by industry observers (e.g., KPMG), the act emphasizes a high degree of transparency through mandatory documentation and reporting. This framework has been further reinforced by the European Union's Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD; Directive (EU) 2024/1760, 2024). Under the CSDDD (2024), which entered into force in 2024 with a phased application starting from 26 July 2028 to 2029, large corporations must assume liability for adverse impacts within their operational spheres. The regulatory framework requires firms to take a comprehensive view of potential risk exposure across their operations, extending responsibility beyond internal activities to include affiliated entities and business partners throughout the supply chain. Key provisions include the adoption of climate-neutral business plans and a phased compliance schedule. However, translating these legal mandates into operational reality presents several significant challenges for the affected enterprises.

One major obstacle is the collection and evaluation of supplier data. Since supply chains often cover many different countries and industries, companies must deal with a wide variety of data formats and standards. This makes it difficult to achieve a clear and transparent view of all potential risks, as firms must find a way to organize fragmented information into a consistent system. Beyond data management, communication with diverse suppliers represents another difficulty. Because suppliers operate in different cultural and legal environments, language barriers and different business habits often hinder the effective implementation of compliance standards.

This process is further complicated by the need for continuous monitoring and adaptation. Unlike traditional audits that happen once a year, the new laws require companies to monitor their supply chains constantly. In this context, the role of the lead company has shifted: rather than immediately ending a contract when a problem arises, companies are now expected to provide training and support to help their partners improve, treating the termination of a partnership only as a last resort. Finally, these responsibilities require a significant investment in digital tools, leading to higher operational and IT costs.

Finally, these responsibilities require a significant investment in digital tools, leading to higher operational and IT costs for the large enterprises directly covered by the law. However, the impact of these regulations extends far beyond multinational corporations, creating a ripple effect that significantly reaches small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs).

While SMEs may not meet the official employee or turnover thresholds for direct coverage, they are indirectly affected by both the LkSG (2021) and the CSDDD (2024). This is because large companies, in their effort to comply with due diligence mandates, increasingly pass these



obligations down to their suppliers through contractual requirements. Consequently, SMEs find themselves in a difficult position; compared to large enterprises, they operate under tighter financial constraints and often lack the internal expertise or organizational capacity to implement complex IT systems.

These characteristics make SMEs particularly sensitive to the gap between strict regulatory demands and the practical limitations of their business models. Many current compliance tools are designed for larger firms, leading to a mismatch when applied to smaller operations. To bridge this gap, SMEs must rely on integrated solutions that allow SMEs to structure compliance processes digitally without requiring enterprise-level resources. Supporting these smaller players in complying with all requirements is essential, as they form the backbone of the value chains that the LkSG (2021) and the CSDDD (2024) aim to regulate.

#### **4.5 Overview and Limitations of Existing Compliance Solutions**

A recurring tension can be observed between the level of regulatory accountability demanded by current due diligence frameworks and the operational capacities of SMEs expected to implement them, creating a distinct void in the compliance software market. Existing digital solutions—ranging from basic workflow tools to complex enterprise GRC systems—fail to satisfy the market’s specific needs, as they either lack the evidentiary depth required for rigorous legal audits or are priced beyond the budgetary reach of smaller firms. While various market players have attempted to address these challenges, they exhibit fundamental limitations when assessed against the dual requirements of SME operational capacity and regulatory accountability.

The resulting landscape is characterized by four distinct strategic players. While each offers specialized capabilities, they vary significantly in their suitability for the SME sector, particularly regarding implementation complexity, technological depth, and service orientation.

##### **4.5.1 Enterprise Ecosystems: SAP GRC**

SAP GRC exemplifies a "governance-first" approach, intrinsically tied to the broader Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) environment. Its primary utility lies in the seamless integration of internal business data, enabling real-time monitoring of financial risks and internal controls. For SMEs, this architecture translates into a high entry threshold, as effective use presupposes existing ERP integration and specialized internal expertise. The system is optimized for large-scale corporations with existing SAP infrastructure, requiring substantial upfront capital and specialized technical expertise. Furthermore, its logic centers on structured internal data, which often proves inadequate for the unstructured external document formats central to LkSG (2021) compliance. Consequently, the typical six-to-twelve-month integration cycle lacks the fast deployment capabilities necessary for firms facing immediate regulatory deadlines.

##### **4.5.2 All-in-One Modular Compliance Hubs: osapiens**

osapiens offers a modular architecture designed for rapid adherence to mandates including the LkSG (2021) and CSDDD (2024). Its competitive advantage is an AI-powered risk management

system that monitors global news to map supply chain transparency. Despite this technical sophistication, the platform’s modularity often results in "functional bloat" for smaller enterprises.

Furthermore, its pricing models, which scale disproportionately with supplier volume and module variety, undermine long-term cost predictability for mid-sized firms. This structure often results in escalating expenses as compliance requirements expand, preventing the cost-efficiency required for sustainable SME operations.

**4.5.3 Collaboration and Documentation Tools: relatico**

Relatico addresses the administrative friction of compliance through automated Supplier Relationship Management (SRM). It excels at digitizing document collection via features like "Tree Builders" for sub-supplier visualization. While highly accessible for SMEs, relatico’s primary focus is on process automation rather than substantive verification. While it ensures a document is successfully collected, it lacks full AI integration and the "Active Intelligence" required to verify the legal rigor of the content within those documents. This creates a "verification gap" where procedural compliance is achieved, but substantive legal risk remains unverified.

**4.5.4 Consulting-led Governance: CONSUST**

Representing a "high-touch" strategic approach, CONSUST prioritizes qualitative aspects of sustainability, such as bespoke codes of conduct and manual facility audits. While this provides high-level strategic alignment, it fundamentally lacks digital scalability. For many SMEs facing tight regulatory timelines, manual and consulting-intensive compliance approaches tend to exceed both time and budget constraints. Such labor-intensive approaches are poorly aligned with regulatory expectations that emphasize ongoing oversight, and they provide limited efficiency gains in terms of cost control and reporting automation.

| Provider | Strategic Focus | Primary Strength             | SME Limitation         |
|----------|-----------------|------------------------------|------------------------|
| SAP GRC  | ERP Governance  | Internal Control Integration | High Cost & Complexity |
| osapiens | Multi-Reg Hub   | End-to-End Transparency      | Functional Bloat       |
| relatico | SRM Automation  | Administrative Efficiency    | Low Verification Depth |
| CONSUST  | Consulting      | Strategic Alignment          | Low Scalability        |

Table 2: Competitive Landscape across Key Dimensions Relevant to SME Compliance

#### **4.5.5 Market Polarization: The Efficiency-Rigor Trade-off**

This comparison highlights a structural void in the current market. Existing solutions are polarized: they either offer high-level process automation that lacks content depth (relatico) or provide high-depth governance through prohibitive technical complexity or manual labor (SAP, osapiens, CONSUST). This fragmentation already indicates that existing solutions address compliance challenges in isolated ways rather than as an integrated operational capability for SMEs.

#### **4.6 Identification of the Competitive Gap**

The preceding analysis reveals recurring limitations across current compliance solutions when assessed from an SME perspective. While existing tools address specific aspects of compliance, they do not combine these elements into an integrated capability that meets both regulatory requirements and organizational constraints.

The competitive gap therefore does not stem from a lack of available tools, but from shortages at the capability level. Three interrelated dimensions characterize this gap.

First, most solutions lack deep document intelligence. Unstructured documents remain the primary carriers of compliance-relevant information, yet automated analysis at scale is largely absent. Consequently, manual review processes persist, undermining both efficiency and consistency.

Second, legal traceability is insufficiently developed. Without explicit links between compliance outputs and specific documentary clauses, auditability remains constrained—an issue of particular relevance in regulation-driven environments where explainability and accountability are essential.

Third, economic and organizational feasibility for SMEs is inadequately addressed. Solutions that prioritize comprehensiveness over usability or affordability leave SMEs without viable compliance options.

Taken together, these constraints suggest that the observed gap is structural in nature, as it arises from design assumptions embedded in existing solution architectures rather than from short-term market inefficiencies.

#### **4.7 Strategic Implications of the Identified Gap**

To assess whether existing compliance solutions are suitable for SMEs, this study applies a structured evaluation framework derived from the operational requirements of the German Mittelstand. Rather than focusing on individual features, solutions are assessed against five core pillars that determine practical adoptability under regulation-driven compliance.

These pillars include:

- fast deployment without extensive implementation projects, which is particularly relevant given short regulatory lead times.
- data residency and compliance with local data protection requirements,
- intuitive usability that does not rely on specialized compliance expertise,
- integration of AI into core compliance processes rather than auxiliary functions, and
- cost efficiency aligned with SMEs budget constraints.

Together, these dimensions capture the minimum conditions under which compliance solutions can be effectively adopted and sustained by SMEs. The following analysis applies this framework to existing market offerings in order to identify persistent capability gaps.

| COMPANY                                                                             | FAST DEPLOYMENT                                                                     | DATA RESIDENCY                                                                      | INTUITIVE USABILITY                                                                 | FULL AI INTEGRATION                                                                   | COST EFFICIENT                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    |    |    |    |    |    |
|    |    |    |    |    |    |
|    |    |    |    |    |    |
|   |    |    |    |    |    |
|  |  |  |  |  |  |

Table 3 Competitor Comparison in Fast Deployment

When evaluated against this framework, clear limitations emerge across current market offerings. Workflow-oriented platforms struggle primarily with evidentiary depth and AI integration, as they depend on supplier self-declarations. Enterprise GRC systems address legal formality but fail on deployment speed, usability, and cost efficiency for SMEs. Dashboard-based ESG tools emphasize reporting and visualization, yet remain detached from document-level verification.

As a result, none of the incumbent solutions successfully integrate all five pillars required by the Mittelstand. While individual dimensions may be addressed in isolation, the absence of an integrated approach prevents these tools from delivering scalable and audit-ready compliance for SMEs.

From a strategic perspective, the limitations observed among incumbent providers are not merely the result of delayed innovation, but of structural constraints embedded in their original design assumptions. Many established solutions were developed for large enterprises, where compliance is managed by specialized teams, long implementation cycles are acceptable, and cost considerations are secondary.

These assumptions do not translate well to SME contexts. Adapting existing architectures to meet requirements such as rapid deployment, intuitive usability, and cost efficiency would require substantial redesign rather than incremental adjustment. As a result, incumbents face significant

path dependency, limiting their ability to respond effectively to the combined demands of regulatory accountability and SME feasibility.

From an industry perspective, the compliance software market is increasingly shaped by regulatory enforcement rather than by discretionary adoption. Unlike conventional enterprise software markets, demand is not driven primarily by efficiency gains or productivity improvements, but by the need to meet externally imposed legal obligations.

In industries where adoption is primarily triggered by legal obligation rather than discretionary efficiency gains, competitive advantage is less likely to stem from incremental feature differentiation and more from the ability to deliver outputs that withstand regulatory scrutiny. Solutions that fail to deliver verifiable, audit-ready outputs face declining relevance, regardless of their functional breadth or market presence. Regulation therefore acts as a structuring force that filters viable solution architectures and constrains the range of sustainable competitive positions.

#### **4.8 Strategic Positioning of Compleasy**

Against the backdrop of the identified competitive gap, Compleasy represents an approach that is designed to merge two dimensions that remain insufficiently integrated in existing market offerings: advanced analytical capability and legally defensible traceability.

Whereas many incumbent solutions emphasize either procedural efficiency or high-level reporting, Compleasy's strategic position derives from its focus on evidence-based compliance. By enabling automated analysis of supplier documentation and linking compliance outputs directly to underlying documentary sources, the system aligns more closely with regulatory expectations for explainability and audit readiness.

Importantly, this positioning does not merely reflect a functional advantage, but a structural one. Competing solutions are constrained by design assumptions that prioritize workflow coordination, visualization, or centralized control, limiting their ability to deliver document-level traceability without fundamental architectural changes. In contrast, Compleasy's architecture is explicitly oriented toward processing unstructured evidence as a core compliance input rather than as a supplementary element.

From a strategic perspective, this configuration places Compleasy in a defensible position relative to both workflow-centric platforms and enterprise-grade compliance systems. Its emphasis on analytical depth and legal traceability, combined with SME-oriented design choices, supports differentiation that is difficult to replicate without substantial redesign of existing solutions.

From an innovation perspective, the identified gap reflects a broader shift in the nature of compliance technologies. Early generations of compliance software focused primarily on digitizing existing processes, such as questionnaires, workflows, and reporting routines. While these approaches improved coordination, they did not fundamentally alter how compliance risks are identified and assessed.

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## 5. Sales and Marketing Strategy

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This chapter outlines how Compleasy will enter the market, acquires customers, and scales revenue over time. It describes our sales strategy, marketing approach, revenue model, partner management, and go-to-market roadmap, with a clear focus on how these elements work together in practice.

We want to focus on how we reach and convert customers, why we prioritize certain channels over others, and when different activities become relevant as the company grows. Detailed financial projections and operational planning are addressed in later chapters; here, the emphasis is on strategic logic, sequencing, and scalability.

Building on this foundation, the sales and marketing strategy is designed to follow a customer-centric and data-driven approach. Early-stage efforts focus on direct sales, targeted digital marketing, and strategic partnerships to validate the value proposition and generate initial demand. As brand awareness increases, scalable channels such as content marketing, referral programs, and platform integrations become more prominent. This phased approach aligns with established marketing theory, which emphasizes aligning channel selection and messaging with customer lifecycle stages and organizational maturity (Kotler & Keller, 2016). By continuously measuring conversion rates, customer acquisition costs, and retention metrics, Compleasy ensures that sales and marketing activities remain efficient, adaptive, and aligned with long-term growth objectives.

### 5.1 Sales Strategy

The following sections outline key aspects of our sales approach. As compliance software is a market requiring trust and close alignment with regulatory and operational realities, we deliberately combine direct sales with a partner-led approach to enable sustainable growth. This hybrid sales model is designed to balance control, credibility, and scalability throughout different stages of the company's development.

#### 5.1.1 Objectives of the Sales Strategy

The objective of the sales strategy is to empirically validate market demand, establish organizational legitimacy within a trust-intensive compliance environment, and create the structural preconditions for scalable growth. Accordingly, sales activities are not primarily oriented toward short-term revenue maximization, but rather toward the generation of learning effects, empirical proof points, and reference customers that facilitate long-term adoption and partner-driven-expansion.

In the beginning, the central objective is to engage closely with a limited number of co-development customers. These early adopters are leveraged to test fundamental assumptions, refine product functionality, and ensure alignment with both regulatory requirements and actual operational processes. In parallel, the acquisition of lighthouse customers is pursued in order to establish credible references for case studies, testimonials, webinars, and partner sales enablement.

Building trust and reputation within the German Mittelstand represents a critical prerequisite for attracting high-quality and strategically aligned long-term partners, as legitimacy is a key driver of adoption in regulated B2B markets (Suchman, 1995).

Consequently, founder-led and consultative sales are employed to generate initial traction, develop deep customer insights, and validate willingness to pay through the conclusion of initial subscription contracts. Toward the end of this phase, the objective is to demonstrate partner viability by jointly closing first customer engagements together with selected partners. A core aim during this period is to provide evidence that Compleasy delivers repeatable and measurable value across heterogeneous customer contexts, including reductions in manual compliance effort, mitigation of regulatory risk, and improved audit readiness.

Subsequently, sales execution is gradually transferred to external partners. The strategic goal is to establish a partner-led sales model in which Compleasy focuses on product development, partner enablement, and quality assurance, while partners assume responsibility for sales execution and customer onboarding. This configuration enables revenue scaling without proportional increases in internal sales resources and contributes to lower customer acquisition costs, consistent with established findings on platform-based and ecosystem-oriented growth strategies.

Overall, sales activities are guided by **three overarching principles**. First, a partner-first orientation ensures that sales efforts reinforce the development and long-term success of the partner ecosystem rather than competing with it. Second, trust building and compliance credibility are prioritized over aggressive sales tactics, reflecting the long adoption cycles and high switching costs typical of compliance software solutions. Third, sales execution remains strongly learning-driven, particularly in the early stages, where insights derived from customer interactions directly inform product development and go-to-market decisions.

### 5.1.2 Sales Channels

Compleasy pursues a **hybrid channel strategy** that combines direct sales in the early stages with a long-term, partner-led distribution model. The selection and utilization of sales channels are deliberately sequenced over time, progressing from predominantly direct sales during market entry, to a hybrid configuration, and ultimately to a partner-dominant model once product-market fit and market acceptance have been sufficiently validated. This phased transition enables the company to retain close control over customer interactions and value proposition articulation in the early stages, while gradually building the organizational and relational capabilities required for indirect and scalable growth (Moore, 2014).

This approach is particularly appropriate in the context of the German Mittelstand, where purchasing decisions in B2B markets are typically characterized by high levels of risk aversion, long decision cycles, and a strong reliance on trust-based relationships and established intermediaries (Venohr & Meyer, 2007). Early direct engagement allows the firm to reduce information asymmetries, address compliance-related concerns, and establish legitimacy in a market environment where credibility represents a key adoption barrier.



Direct sales are therefore employed selectively and with a clearly defined strategic purpose. In the initial phase, direct customer interactions serve to acquire first customers, validate core assumptions regarding customer needs and willingness to pay, and generate detailed insights into regulatory and operational requirements. Founder-led and consultative sales approaches further enable the systematic collection of qualitative feedback, which is particularly relevant in compliance-oriented software markets characterized by heterogeneous customer processes. Once product-market fit has been established, a structured transition toward a partner-default go-to-market model enables broader market coverage without incurring the high fixed costs associated with scaling an internal sales organization (York, 2018).

Following the empirical validation of partner viability, external partners become the primary route to market. In accordance with established B2B channel management literature, formal governance mechanisms are implemented to minimize channel conflict and ensure coordination between direct and indirect sales activities (Anderson, Narus, & Van Rossum, 2006). These mechanisms include clearly defined rules for lead ownership, standardized qualification criteria, and transparent handover processes. Such structures are particularly relevant in the German B2B context, where role clarity, contractual reliability, and long-term cooperation are critical determinants of successful partner relationships (Gersch, Hewing, & Schöler, 2018).

From a scalability perspective, the chosen channel mix enables revenue growth without a proportional increase in internal headcount. By leveraging partner networks with established access to Mittelstand customers, Compleasy can scale its market presence while concentrating internal resources on product development, partner enablement, and quality assurance. Overall, the channel strategy supports controlled growth, operational efficiency, and sustained credibility in a highly regulated B2B market environment.

#### **5.1.2.1 Direct Sales**

Direct sales are primarily employed to initiate market entry and secure the first lighthouse customers. This channel enables close and continuous interaction with customers and provides direct feedback that is essential for refining the product, pricing logic, and sales narrative. High-touch engagement during the early market entry phase is particularly important for systematically capturing voice-of-customer insights, which support iterative improvements of product features and positioning (Blank, 2020). In addition, these early customer relationships contribute to the development of reference cases and empirical proof points that are critical for partner enablement and the establishment of market credibility.

Sales activities in this phase are predominantly founder-led and follow a consultative sales approach. Customer interactions are problem-oriented and focus on understanding regulatory pressure, operational complexity, and existing organizational workflows. Founder-led sales are especially effective in early-stage ventures, as founders are able to directly translate customer feedback into product and strategy adjustments, thereby reducing coordination delays between sales and product development (Levine, 2021).



The primary emphasis lies on inbound lead generation, such as website demo requests, LinkedIn thought leadership content, webinars, and white papers. In parallel, selective outbound activities are conducted to approach ICP-aligned prospects, for example through targeted LinkedIn outreach and limited cold-calling initiatives.

#### 5.1.2.2 Partnerships

Partnerships form the core distribution channel for mid- to long-term growth, enabling broader market reach and scalable delivery by leveraging the existing customer relationships and trust of established partners. By utilizing established intermediaries, firms can leverage pre-existing trust, which significantly reduces the sales cycle for business-critical software (Chesbrough, 2006). System integrators and IT service providers primarily act as resellers, while compliance and ESG consultants as well as specialised law firms serve as referral partners. These partners already maintain close relationships with their customers and understand both regulatory and integration contexts, which significantly reduces the sales, onboarding, and ongoing support effort required from Compleasy.

This channel choice is driven by the strong preference of companies to work with trusted intermediaries and advisors when addressing business-critical and compliance-relevant topics. The detailed mechanics of partner acquisition, onboarding, enablement, and governance are addressed separately in the Partner Management chapter.

#### 5.1.3 Targeting & Positioning

At its core, Compleasy addresses a single and clearly defined **job-to-be-done** enabling companies to ensure compliance with supply chain due diligence obligations while minimizing internal organizational effort.

The *primary* target group consists of small and medium-sized enterprises with approximately 250 to 2,000 employees that operate international, multi-tier supply chains and are exposed to elevated sourcing risks in regions such as Bangladesh, Vietnam, China, and India. The initial industry focus lies on the textile and electronics sectors, where supply chain complexity and regulatory exposure are particularly pronounced. In later stages, the target scope can be extended to adjacent industries with comparable risk profiles. These firms are either directly subject to the German Supply Chain Due Diligence Act (LkSG) or indirectly affected through compliance requirements imposed by larger business partners and forthcoming EU-wide regulation under the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD) (BMAS, 2021; European Commission, 2022).

In addition to end customers, service providers that manage compliance-related activities for multiple client organizations represent a *secondary* target segment.

From a **buyer perspective**, Compleasy addresses several stakeholder roles with differing decision rationales. Economic buyers, including managing directors, chief financial officers, and compliance leads, are primarily motivated by risk mitigation, cost avoidance, and audit security.

Primary users such as compliance officers, procurement teams, and sustainability managers place greater emphasis on usability, time savings, and operational transparency. External stakeholders, including consultants, auditors, and system integrators, influence purchasing decisions and prioritize reliability, traceability, and seamless integration into existing compliance processes.

Within the **competitive landscape**, Compleasy is positioned between comprehensive enterprise-grade GRC platforms and narrowly specialized compliance tools or consulting-based solutions. Compared to enterprise systems such as SAP-based GRC platforms, Compleasy offers a more focused, faster-to-deploy, and cost-efficient alternative tailored to SME requirements. In contrast to specialized LkSG tools that rely predominantly on checklist-based and manual processes, Compleasy differentiates itself through AI-supported document intelligence and automated risk assessment. Relative to consulting approaches, the platform follows a software-first model that enables scalable compliance execution without service-intensive manual intervention.

Compleasy positions itself as an AI-enabled compliance operations platform designed specifically for SMEs. Its value proposition combines high usability with measurable efficiency gains. The platform automates a substantial share of due-diligence activities, delivers traceable and audit-ready outputs aligned with LkSG and CSDDD obligations, and operates exclusively on EU- and Germany-hosted infrastructure to ensure full data residency. Rapid integration allows organizations to begin usage within a short timeframe and without extensive IT projects, while configurable workflows accommodate heterogeneous supplier structures and documentation requirements. An AI-based chatbot further supports users by providing explainable responses derived from compliance-relevant data.

Accordingly, the **core value proposition** can be summarized as follows: Compleasy transforms complex supply chain due-diligence obligations into a fast, transparent, and secure process by automating document analysis, risk assessment, and reporting through Germany-hosted AI and Mittelstand-oriented workflows. Positioning and messaging are applied consistently across sales, marketing, and partner channels, with adaptations in emphasis and language for decision-makers, operational users, and partners.

#### 5.1.4 Sales Process

The sales process described below primarily applies to direct sales but can also act as a blueprint for partner playbooks. A strong emphasis is placed on early qualification to ensure sales efforts are focused on high-fit prospects rather than volume.



Figure 3 Sales Pipeline

**Lead generation** is driven mainly through inbound channels such as webinars, white papers, events, and targeted online presence. Leads are classified as marketing-qualified leads (MQLs) once they match with the ICP, show regulatory exposure, and engage with marketing offerings.

The objective of the **lead qualification** stage is to validate demand and assess the customer's compliance pain points, typically conducted via a structured discovery call. Leads are promoted to sales-qualified leads (SQLs) once there is clarity on decision authority, budget availability, and timeline (usually within the next six months).

For qualified opportunities, the next step is a focused **product demo**. Rather than a broad feature overview, the demo concentrates on core value drivers (instant insights, traceability), paying particular attention to critical trust factors (e.g., data sovereignty, explainability).

Most customers then enter a **paid proof-of-concept** phase lasting about four to eight weeks, which is scoped to a limited number of suppliers, typically between ten and twenty, to ensure fast results and clear evaluation. During this phase, Compleasy delivers measurable outcomes such as time saved, improved risk visibility, and structured compliance outputs. This phase concludes with a report that supports the customer's internal decision-making for a full rollout.

Successful POCs lead into **conversion**, with customers signing a subscription agreement. This step includes an initial onboarding and a structured handover either to the internal customer success team or, where applicable, to a certified implementation partner.

After the initial rollout, **after-sales** activities focus on account expansion and long-term value creation, like introducing add-on modules.

## 5.2 Marketing strategy

This sub-chapter outlines how Compleasy approaches marketing to build trust, generate demand, and support both direct sales and partner-led distribution. It covers marketing objectives, channel selection, and positioning/messaging, explaining how these elements are aligned with the overall strategy.

Marketing plays a critical role because compliance software is a trust-driven product. Therefore, the marketing strategy is designed not only to generate leads, but also to establish Compleasy as a credible solution for supply chain compliance in the Mittelstand.

### 5.2.1 Objectives of the Marketing Strategy

The primary objective of Compleasy's marketing activities is to establish trust and credibility among potential adopters. As the software directly influences legal risk exposure and audit outcomes, marketing efforts must primarily reduce perceived adoption risk and clearly signal reliability and professionalism. This is achieved through the consistent communication of core elements of the value proposition, such as traceable legal outputs and data residency, as well as through expert-backed and regulatory-focused content that reinforces Compleasy's positioning as a professional compliance solution (Edelman, 2023; Morgan & Hunt, 1994).

A second central objective is the generation of high-quality inbound leads that closely match the defined Ideal Customer Profile (ICP). Rather than maximising lead volume, marketing activities are designed to attract organisations that are already subject to the German Supply Chain Due

Diligence Act (LkSG) or are actively preparing for upcoming regulations such as the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD). These qualified leads support founder-led sales in the early stages and contribute to the development of a focused and efficient sales pipeline (Kotler & Keller, 2016; Halligan & Shah, 2014).

Marketing further plays a critical role in enabling and supporting the partner strategy. It provides partners with credible sales collateral and co-branded content that strengthens their customer-facing discussions, while simultaneously generating inbound demand that can be transferred to partners. In addition, marketing contributes to market education by explaining regulatory developments and highlighting the operational challenges associated with compliance execution, thereby further enhancing credibility and thought leadership (Kotler et al., 2021).

Finally, marketing functions as a feedback mechanism for validating and refining market positioning. Campaign performance, content engagement, and customer interactions are systematically analysed to test value propositions, messaging approaches, and common objections. The resulting insights are fed back into sales narratives and product development, ensuring continuous alignment between market expectations and the offered solution (Kotler & Keller, 2016).

### 5.2.2 Marketing Channels

Compleasy's marketing channels are deliberately selected to build credibility, support sales activities, and enable partners, rather than to maximise reach or lead volume, reflecting a clear preference for depth over breadth. Channel selection prioritises trustworthiness, relevance to the Ideal Customer Profile (ICP), and alignment with the partner-led go-to-market strategy, while deliberately avoiding consumer-oriented channels that are unsuitable for a compliance-driven B2B purchasing process (Kotler & Keller, 2016; Gartner, 2023).

**Consistency** across all channels is considered essential. Messaging, regulatory statements, and overall positioning are closely aligned with the sales narrative and governed by clearly defined guidelines. This includes rules for partner use of marketing materials, co-branding standards, and compliant wording when referencing legal or regulatory outcomes. Such governance ensures a coherent and professional market presence while reducing the risk of confusion or legal misrepresentation (Morgan & Hunt, 1994; Kotler et al., 2021).

Channel **performance** is continuously monitored with a strong emphasis on lead quality rather than volume. Metrics such as lead source relevance and qualification level are tracked on an ongoing basis and used to refine the channel mix and improve messaging effectiveness over time. This quality-focused measurement approach supports efficient resource allocation and strengthens alignment with sales objectives (Halligan & Shah, 2014).

Channel **prioritisation** evolves in line with the company's stage of maturity. In the early phases, marketing relies primarily on owned and earned channels, while paid channels are used only selectively. As the partner ecosystem expands, earned media and partner-driven visibility gain importance. Paid marketing activities are increasingly applied to support partner pipelines and

targeted, regulation-driven campaigns, ensuring scalability without compromising credibility (Kotler & Keller, 2016; Gartner, 2023).

#### **5.2.2.1 Owned Channels**

Owned channels constitute the foundation of the marketing strategy, as they provide full control over messaging and function as long-term assets for credibility building, education, and enablement. The company website serves as the central hub, featuring problem- and regulation-oriented landing pages tailored to the needs of compliance-driven buyers. Thought leadership content, including blog articles, regulatory explainers, and legal updates, supports continuous market education. In addition, white papers, compliance guides, and case studies with lighthouse customers contribute to trust-building, while sales and partner enablement materials ensure consistent communication across all touchpoints. These channels are particularly critical in a compliance-focused B2B context, as buyers typically conduct extensive independent research prior to vendor engagement. As such, owned content supports both high-quality inbound lead generation and partner-led sales activities (Kotler & Keller, 2016; Halligan & Shah, 2014).

#### **5.2.2.2 Earned Channels**

Earned channels are employed to generate third-party validation and transfer trust from recognised experts, institutions, and partners to Compleasy. Joint webinars and co-hosted events with partners play a central role, complemented by guest articles and expert interviews in industry-specific media. Selective conference participation, panel discussions, partner endorsements, and word-of-mouth recommendations further extend reach and reinforce credibility. Earned channels are especially effective in reducing sales friction, as compliance-related purchasing decisions are strongly influenced by external validation and expert opinions. By leveraging credible third parties, these channels help mitigate perceived risk and support decision-making in complex regulatory environments (Morgan & Hunt, 1994; Edelman, 2023).

#### **5.2.2.3 Paid Channels**

Paid channels are used selectively and in a tactical manner, with a clear focus on targeted amplification rather than broad-based awareness. Their primary purpose is to support specific campaigns, regulatory milestones, or lower-funnel activities such as retargeting. Key instruments include highly targeted LinkedIn advertising based on role, industry, and geography, sponsored webinars, placements in compliance-focused newsletters and media outlets, as well as selective participation in relevant industry events and trade fairs. These channels are deliberately chosen to ensure efficient budget utilisation while preserving the credibility-driven positioning of the brand. Paid marketing thus complements owned and earned channels without diluting trust or professional legitimacy (Kotler et al., 2021; Gartner, 2023).

### **5.2.3 Positioning & Messaging**

Compleasy's positioning is based on a clearly defined and focused market category. The product is positioned as an *AI-powered operational compliance platform designed specifically for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs)*. It deliberately differentiates itself from complex enterprise-

grade GRC systems and manual, service-heavy consulting approaches by emphasising execution and verifiable evidence rather than strategic advisory services. Simplicity, speed, and affordability are prioritised, while maintaining a high level of regulatory robustness. This positioning is applied consistently across marketing and sales activities to ensure a coherent and recognisable market perception (Kotler & Keller, 2016).

The core **value narrative** functions as a single source of truth for all messaging activities. Compleasy's central value proposition is the provision of instant, secure, and traceable answers to supply chain compliance obligations. This promise is supported by four key pillars: legal certainty, time and cost efficiency, high usability, and strict data sovereignty. The narrative is consistently framed around the reduction of compliance risk and the operational burden associated with regulatory execution.

Messaging is adapted to different target **audiences** while preserving a consistent core message. For economic decision-makers, such as managing directors and compliance leads, communication focuses on risk mitigation, cost avoidance, and liability reduction. For primary users, messaging emphasises usability, time savings, and clarity in day-to-day compliance activities. Partner-facing communication highlights scalability, reliability, and the ability to integrate seamlessly into existing service offerings.

From a **lead generation** perspective, messaging is closely aligned with regulatory urgency and concrete operational pain points. Communication addresses specific requirements arising from the LkSG and the upcoming CSDDD, the complexity of supplier data management, and the high effort associated with manual compliance processes. Abstract ESG terminology is deliberately avoided in favour of practical use cases and clearly defined outcomes. Calls to action are aligned with the respective stage of the buyer journey, ranging from educational formats such as guides and webinars to validation-oriented content such as case studies.

**Content** plays a central role in reinforcing both positioning and trust. All content follows defined principles: it is expert-driven, precise, practical, and credibility-oriented rather than promotional. Educational content, including best-practice articles, webinars, and workshops, is prioritised and complemented by authority-building formats such as case studies from pilot customers, expert interviews, and commentary on regulatory developments (Edelman, 2023).

As partner enablement is an integral component of the overall marketing strategy, clear guidelines define how Compleasy is positioned alongside consulting, legal, and integration services. This ensures consistent and compliant communication across all partner-led customer interactions.

Positioning and messaging are continuously refined through structured **feedback loops**. Insights from sales conversations, partner feedback, and content performance are systematically analysed and used to adjust messaging over time. As regulatory frameworks evolve and the product matures, the positioning is updated to remain relevant, precise, and aligned with changing market requirements.



### 5.3 Revenue Model

|                                                                           |                                                                                |                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Starter</b><br><i>Up to 10 suppliers / 100 documents</i><br>→ 3.600€   |                                                                                |                                                                                  |
| <b>Small</b><br><i>Up to 50 suppliers /<br/>500 documents</i><br>→ 8.900€ | <b>Medium</b><br><i>Up to 300 suppliers /<br/>3.000 documents</i><br>→ 18.900€ | <b>Large</b><br><i>Up to 1.000 suppliers /<br/>10.000 documents</i><br>→ 45.000€ |
| <b>Enterprise</b><br><i>Custom limits</i><br>→ Custom pricing             |                                                                                |                                                                                  |

Figure 4 Pricing Model

Compleasy follows a **subscription-based SaaS revenue model** designed to reflect the operational reality of supply chain compliance. Pricing scales with the number of suppliers and the volume of documents processed, creating a direct and transparent link between price, compliance workload, automation value, and risk exposure. This approach allows customers to clearly understand what they are paying for and ensures predictable annual costs.

The pricing structure is organised into clearly defined tiers to address different levels of complexity and volume. The core plans (*Small*, *Medium*, and *Large*) are designed for SMEs, increasing with supplier counts and document volumes. A *Starter* plan offers a low-barrier entry point for smaller companies or early-stage compliance efforts. It is intentionally limited in scope and functionality, primarily serving as an onboarding and upsell path into the core plans. For companies that exceed the limits of the *Large* plan or require more complex setups, an *Enterprise* option is available with custom pricing. This tier avoids artificial thresholds and allows flexibility for special requirements, but it is not the primary sales focus. The core target remains the German Mittelstand within the defined pricing tiers.

All core subscription plans (*Small*, *Medium*, and *Large*) include the same functional feature set. This ensures a consistent product experience across the target SME segment and avoids unnecessary complexity customers. Pricing differences between these plans are driven exclusively by scale factors such as supplier count and document volume, which directly reflect compliance workload and risk exposure. Additional advanced features may be offered as optional add-on modules. This add-on structure allows customers to tailor the platform to their specific needs while preserving transparency and a clear link between incremental value and incremental cost, providing an additional revenue potential without increasing core plan complexity.

Overall, pricing is value-driven and directly tied to actual compliance workload and risk exposure, aligning it with typical Mittelstand budgets and the financial impact of LkSG and CSDDD obligations. Large enterprise GRC platforms are often priced for global organisations with deep

regulatory needs and extensive feature sets, leading to high annual costs that can exceed six figures (Monetizely, 2025). In contrast, consulting-heavy compliance approaches may offer tailored services, but they frequently result in unpredictable and project-based costs due to hourly rates, scope creep, and variable engagement structures (Zipursky, 2025). Compared to niche LkSG/CSDDD tools that primarily provide basic workflow support or checklist automation without deeper evidence extraction and analytics (Forvis Mazars, n.d.), Compleasy aims to deliver superior functional depth, providing a long-term solution as regulatory requirements evolve.

Contracts are offered on an annual basis by default, with incentives for multi-year commitments. Quarterly contracts are possible at a higher price point to reflect increased commercial risk.

To reduce adoption risk and avoid pricing friction, threshold exceedances (e.g. supplier or document limits) are handled transparently by notifying customers early and offering structured upgrade paths rather than sudden price increases. This mechanism protects customer trust, supports long-term retention, and prevents compliance interruptions caused by rigid plan limits.

Compleasy's revenue model enables **high gross-margin scalability**, which is typical for SaaS solutions once the core platform is established. The marginal cost of product usage (particularly for AI-driven document analysis and automation) is negligible in relation to overall earnings. The primary cost drivers are customer-facing activities such as onboarding, integration, and ongoing support rather than software usage itself.

The high gross-margin SaaS economics enable a partner-led distribution model at scale. Low marginal software costs allow substantial value capture even when implementation, onboarding, and first-level support are delegated to certified partners. This model extends delivery capacity and market reach (no proportional growth in internal resources), while preserving margins, making partner-led execution not only economically viable but the best possible option for sustainable growth. These partners receive a recurring revenue share on subscription revenue, typically around 20-30 %. Early partners may benefit from (time limited) higher commission rates (up to 50 %), to incentivise early adoption, co-development, and market entry support. Detailed partner revenue mechanics will be covered in a later chapter.

## 5.4 Partner Management

In this sub-chapter we elaborate on how Compleasy builds, enables, and governs its partner ecosystem as a core element of the sales and marketing strategy. It covers the following aspects: partner strategy, acquisition approach, onboarding and certification, revenue mechanics, enablement and support, as well as performance management and quality control.

Partner management is critical to the Compleasy business model because scalable growth is primarily driven through its partners rather than direct sales. A structured partner model ensures consistent quality, regulatory reliability, and a clear division of roles, while allowing Compleasy to scale market reach, onboarding capacity, and customer support without proportional internal growth.



### 5.4.1 Partner Strategy

Partners play a central strategic role in Compleasy's business model, not only as a delivery channel but also to create synergies for marketing (joint activities) and product development (feedback loop). The partner approach is designed to enable scalable growth without proportional increases in internal sales headcount, onboarding capacity, or support resources.

Compleasy applies two complementary **partnership models**. The primary model is a reseller and delivery model in which partners sell the software, lead implementation and integration, and provide first-level customer support. In return, partners receive a recurring revenue share. This model is primarily designed for system integrators, as they are well positioned to handle these operational and technical responsibilities. A structured certification process ensures consistent quality and regulatory compliance.

The secondary model is referral-based. Compliance and ESG consultants as well as specialised law firms identify and qualify suitable leads (in return for a commission), while Compleasy remains responsible for sales execution and delivery. This model leverages the partners' advisory role and trusted customer relationships while requiring a lower level of operational commitment. It also serves as an entry point for partners who are not yet ready to take on delivery responsibilities.

**Partner marketing** is an integral part of the overall strategy. Compleasy works with partners to co-create content such as white papers and practical compliance guides, co-host webinars and events, and develop joint case studies. These activities increase mutual visibility, enable trust transfer, and ensure consistent messaging towards shared target audiences.

To ensure clarity and avoid conflicts, **partner governance** will be clearly defined from the outset. This includes rules for lead ownership, deal registration, and channel conflict resolution, as well as standardised partner agreements that define roles, responsibilities, and commercial terms. While partners are empowered to represent and deliver the solution, Compleasy retains strategic control over product development, pricing, and core messaging.

Managing **partner dependency** is a key risk consideration. The partner portfolio is intentionally diversified to avoid reliance on individual partners. This approach increases resilience and preserves strategic flexibility as the ecosystem grows.

The partner strategy follows a phased **roadmap**. In the early stages, partnerships focus on co-development and pilot customer projects. As the first reseller partners are onboarded, a structured certification program and partner portal are rolled out. Over time, these partners increasingly become more important, as the primary delivery and sales channel.

### 5.4.2 Partner Acquisition

Partner acquisition is approached in a targeted and selective manner. The goal is not to build a large partner network quickly, but to onboard a limited number of high-quality partners that fit the strategic direction of Compleasy and are willing to invest in a long-term collaboration. In the early phase, the focus lies on mid-sized system integrators and boutique compliance or ESG

consultancies. Large, multi-national integrators are deliberately deprioritised at this stage due to longer cycles, higher coordination effort, and lower willingness to co-develop early-stage solutions.

Priority is given to partners with an existing Mittelstand customer base and a clear focus on compliance, ESG, or supply chain-related topics. Willingness to co-develop, provide structured feedback, and invest early resources is a key selection criterion.

The **partner value proposition** is communicated clearly and consistently during acquisition. Compleasy enables partners to offer a scalable, software-based compliance solution without the need to build or maintain their own technology. Partners benefit from a recurring revenue share, reduced delivery effort, and a differentiated offering. The focus is on enabling faster project execution, higher margins per engagement, and stronger long-term customer retention.

Partner acquisition is driven through a combination of direct outreach and inbound interest. Targeted system integrators and consultancies are approached directly using existing networks, industry associations, and selective participation in expert-focused events and conferences. In parallel, inbound interest is generated through a thought leadership oriented online presence.

Attraction and qualification are closely linked. Messaging clearly outlines what types of partners we are working with, managing expectations regarding level of commitment and other parameters. Over-rapid onboarding is avoided to ensure quality and alignment.

The **acquisition process** is structured to validate strategic fit before formal commitment. It typically starts with a partner pitch covering the product, revenue model, and expected responsibilities. This is followed by an evaluation phase, which may include a pilot collaboration or a joint customer opportunity. A formal partnership agreement is only pursued once mutual fit and collaboration potential have been validated.

Early partners are incentivised through clearly defined benefits. These may include higher revenue shares, increased visibility through co-marketing activities, and influence on the product roadmap. Incentives are time-bound to create urgency while maintaining fairness as the partner ecosystem grows.

The legal and commercial framework is standardised to reduce friction. Partner agreements clearly define roles, revenue attribution, and intellectual property boundaries, while standardised processes and templates ensure efficient contracting.

Finally, partner acquisition is actively managed to maintain balance. Target numbers of partners are defined per phase, with attention to geographic and industry coverage. Avoiding oversaturation will protect partner economics and ensure a high level of engagement.

#### 5.4.3 Partner Onboarding & Certification

The objective is to enable partners to sell, implement, and support Compleasy independently and with confidence. A structured onboarding approach reduces dependency on internal Compleasy

resources while ensuring consistent quality, and a professional customer experience across all partner-led engagements.

**Partner onboarding** follows a standardised process. It covers a product and compliance overview, including the regulatory context of LkSG and CSDDD, as well as training on the commercial and pricing model. Partners are introduced to the sales narrative, typical use cases, and objection handling to ensure consistent positioning in customer conversations. The onboarding process follows a clear timeline, typically lasting about four weeks, and includes defined readiness criteria that must be met before a partner is allowed to actively sell and deliver the solution.

To maintain quality and incentivise long-term commitment, Compleasy operates a tiered partner **certification program**. Entry-level registered partners complete basic training covering product functionality, pricing logic, compliance context, and sales fundamentals. At this level, partners receive the standard revenue share. Advanced partners complete additional training modules, including deeper product features, data protection requirements, and implementation best practices. They qualify for co-marketing activities and benefit from an increased revenue share. Global partners demonstrate proven customer acquisition and retention capabilities and are authorised to distribute Compleasy across additional EU markets, receiving the highest revenue share tier.



Figure 5 Partner Certification Concept

**Quality assurance** is embedded in the certification model. Partners are required to undergo periodic recertification, typically on an annual basis, to stay aligned with regulatory changes, product updates, and messaging guidelines. This ensures that customer-facing communication remains accurate, compliant, and consistent over time.

All onboarding, training, and enablement activities are supported through a **central partner portal**. This portal serves as the single source of truth for training materials, sales assets, technical documentation, and product updates. It ensures that partners always have access to the latest information and can operate efficiently and independently.

#### 5.4.4 Partner Revenue Mechanics

The **partner revenue model** is designed to make Compleasy economically attractive as a core offering, not just an auxiliary tool, while aligning incentives for long-term customer success.

Under the reseller and delivery model, partners receive a recurring revenue share on subscription revenues, with rates increasing by certification tier (Registered – 20%, Advanced 25%, Global – 30%; PartnerStack, 2024). This structure rewards long-term engagement, customer retention, and volume rather than one-off deal closures. In the referral model, partners receive a one-time

for qualified leads that convert to paying customers (15% of the first year's contract value; Minh, 2025).

Typical deal sizes in the Mittelstand segment (Medium/Large tier) are large enough to justify sales and delivery effort (Bahadur, 2024), while the standardized product and automation-driven compliance workflows significantly reduce implementation complexity. This allows system integrators to achieve high effective margins per engagement.

Partners generate value over time in multiple ways. In addition to recurring subscription commissions, they benefit from upsell opportunities (add-on modules) and higher subscription bases as customers expand supplier volumes. This creates a predictable, annuity-like revenue stream rather than project-based income.

To prevent partners from treating Compleasy as “just another tool”, revenue and other benefits are tightly linked to certification and performance. Higher margins and co-marketing benefits are only available to partners who actively sell, implement, and support the platform according to defined quality standards.

#### 5.4.5 Partner Enablement & Support

Enablement is designed to minimise reliance on internal Compleasy teams and to allow partners to operate efficiently. The objective is to ensure that partners can sell, onboard, and support customers independently while maintaining a consistent and high-quality customer experience.

**Sales enablement** provides partners with structured and reusable materials that support confident and consistent customer conversations. This includes partner sales kits with pitch decks, clearly articulated value propositions, competitive comparisons, and objection-handling guides.

**Technical and product enablement** focuses on practical execution. Providing partners with step-by-step onboarding playbooks, integration and configuration guides, and educational material for the Compleasy platform. Demo environments and sandbox access allow partners to familiarise themselves with the product and run customer demonstrations.

**Marketing enablement** complements sales and delivery by supporting partner-led demand generation. Partners are provided with co-branded marketing assets, ready-to-use webinar and event materials, and selected white-label content options. In addition, partners gain visibility through listings and references on Compleasy's own channels, supporting inbound interest.

Support responsibilities are clearly defined to avoid friction and ensure fast resolution of issues. Partners own first-level customer support and act as the primary point of contact for customers. Compleasy retains responsibility for technical support related to product defects, platform issues, and complex escalations. A tiered support structure is in place, supported by a dedicated partner success manager, clear communication channels, and regular check-ins to address questions and share updates.

All enablement and support activities are consolidated in the central partner portal, which serves as a single access point for the partner knowledge base, training materials, sales assets, technical documentation, FAQs, and troubleshooting guides. This ensures that partners always work with current information and can operate independently at scale.

#### 5.4.6 Partner Performance Management & Quality Control

Performance management and quality control ensure that partner-led delivery meets Compleasy's standards for reliability and customer experience. This framework protects brand integrity while enabling consistent quality at scale. It also allows early identification of high-performing partners as well as potential issues that require corrective action.

Partner performance is assessed using a defined set of **key performance indicators**. Commercial metrics include the number of active customers, conversion rates, revenue contribution, and deal velocity. Operational performance is monitored through support-related indicators such as ticket volume and resolution times. Customer outcomes are measured using satisfaction scores, renewal and churn rates, and the success of expansion and upsell activities. Together, these metrics provide a balanced view of the overall performance.

This is complemented by a structured **feedback and improvement loop**. Partners provide regular feedback on product usage, customer requirements, and delivery challenges. These insights are fed back into the product roadmap, training materials, and enablement processes to continuously improve the platform and the partner experience.

**Performance reviews** are conducted on a regular basis, with frequency depending on the partner's certification level. All relevant data is collected in central systems (e.g., CRM, partner portal) to ensure transparency and comparability across the partners.

Clear **incentives and consequences** are linked to performance outcomes. High-performing partners may benefit from certification upgrades, higher revenue shares, and increased visibility through co-marketing activities. Underperformance can lead to certification downgrades, reduced commissions, or, in persistent cases, termination of the partnership. This approach ensures accountability while rewarding partners who consistently deliver value to customers.

#### 5.5 Go-To-Market Strategy

This section defines Compleasy's go-to-market strategy as a phased market-entry roadmap. The focus is on sequencing, readiness criteria, and operational prerequisites, rather than detailing channel execution, marketing tactics, pricing, or partner relationship models, which are addressed in their respective chapters above.

Because supply-chain compliance is a trust-critical domain, our market entry follows a deliberate progression. First, we want to validate value in real workflows, next we make the delivery repeatable and then we want to scale distribution only once product reliability and governance are robust and proven.

Two principles guide the strategy: First, commercialization must not outpace trust and reliability. In compliance contexts, adoption depends on transparency, consistency of outputs, and clear responsibility boundaries. Secondly, scale is earned through repeatability. Compleasy scales only once customer onboarding, support, and outcomes can be delivered consistently without disproportionate manual effort.

Compleasy enters the German market in three phases. Each phase is defined by:

1. Objectives that must be achieved,
2. Readiness deliverables, that must be built or standardized, and
3. Exit criteria that determine phase completion.

This structure reduces execution risk and ensures that commercialization does not outpace product reliability, data governance, and delivery capacity. It is important that the phases themselves are not bound to a certain timeframe, but to the objectives that define each phase. Time expectancies for all three phases are part of the implementation plan that is also part of this business plan.

While general Sales, Marketing and Pricing are covered in earlier chapters, the go-to-market roadmap addresses the conditions that determine whether the product will be adopted and retained.

For Compleasy, adoption depends on four constraints that must be satisfied in sequence:

1. **Operational fit:** Customers must be able to use Compleasy with the documents and processes they already have.
2. **Outcome credibility:** Outputs must be consistent, explainable, and usable for internal review and external stakeholder requests.
3. **Governance clarity:** Customers must understand that Compleasy supports and structures compliance work but does not provide legal guarantees; the review/finalization responsibility remains with the customer.
4. **Repeatable delivery:** Onboarding and ongoing usage must become predictable, otherwise scaling increases support costs and risks brand trust.

These constraints are directly reflected in the three-phase roadmap below.

### 5.5.1 Phase 1 - Co-Development & Proof of Value (Pilot Phase)

The objective of Phase 1 is to prove that Compleasy creates real customer value end-to-end, using real supplier documentation and realistic data quality. The goal is not broad exposure but to validate usefulness and credibility. It also establishes the minimum trust requirements needed in a compliance product: transparency of assessments, clear product boundaries, and reliable data handling.

The Focus is to execute co-development with three to five companies in the German textile segment. These customers represent the typical target situation. We are looking for limited compliance resources, high document burden, and supplier networks in higher-risk regions. We plan to acquire them through direct outreach and participation in industry events.

We see them as potential “lighthouse customers” that provide strong validation, structured feedback, and, where possible, future testimonial and case study potential to support the transition into monetization.

In exchange for intensive feedback and active usage, co-development customers receive the product free of charge for two years and are supported closely with high-touch onboarding and test runs. The goal is to generate validated outcomes, reference readiness and a repeatable pilot onboarding.

**Key deliverables**

- End-to-end workflow works reliably in real conditions
- Transparent rationale and governance baseline.
- Repeatable pilot onboarding and structured feedback loop.

**Exit criteria**

- Pilot customers complete at least one full cycle and confirm usability of outputs.
- Governance boundaries are clear and enforceable in process and documentation.
- Onboarding steps are repeatable across different pilots.

**5.5.2 Phase 2 - Start of Monetization (Early Adopters)**

After pilot validation, the objective of this phase is to convert the validated value into paid adoption while making delivery predictable and scalable for a growing customer base.

We will target early adopters within the same profile as in phase 1. Customers are still acquired primarily through direct sales with product demos and short trials, focusing on buyers such as CEOs, Heads of Procurement or Compliance leads.

To reduce adoption friction, as an incentive to use our product and to accelerate learning, we plan to offer strongly discounted early adopter contracts, aiming for an average of ~50% discount across the first 20 customers. This creates a controlled increase of paid usage while improving onboarding efficiency and product robustness.

**Key deliverables**

- Standardized onboarding that consistently delivers value quickly.
- Stable output quality across customers with traceability and governance.



- Support routines that remain manageable as customer count increases.

**Exit criteria**

- Paying customers repeatedly reach value via standardized onboarding.
- Onboarding and support effort becomes measurable and decreases over time.
- Output consistency is stable across different customer setups.

**5.5.3 Phase 3 - Scale Preparation & First Partner Program**

The objective of this phase is to prepare Compleasy for growth without linear increases in manual effort and without undermining trust. Customer acquisition continues, but Phase 3 shifts emphasis from selling more to delivering at scale. From the feedback and experiences of the first two phases, we plan to prepare a scalable implementation standard, including documentation, templates and guided onboarding. That way additional delivery capacity can be added without degrading quality. This phase also sets the basis for broader rollout beyond the initial segment and for future channel scaling.

In parallel, we will initiate a first structured partner outreach to secure the first one or two implementation and distribution partners. The goal of this initial partner wave is to validate a partner led delivery model under controlled conditions, ensuring quality remains consistent when onboarding and support are executed externally. We also want to establish the first repeatable enablement assets, such as partner training, implementation checklists, and standardized handover routines. Partners, with a focus on IT system integrators, will be selected based on their existing SME customer access in the targeted industries, their experience with cloud software rollouts and operational support and ideally their ability to serve as a credibility layer for compliance-related solutions.

To make the partnership attractive from the start, we will offer higher partner margins, free onboarding and enablement, as well as dedicated early-stage support, including joint customer onboarding and escalation paths.

**Key deliverables**

- Scalable operating model through documentation, self-serve onboarding components, and standard delivery routines that reduce manual effort per customer.
- IT system integrators partner readiness, with enablement package, free onboarding and support for partners
- Trust & adaptability safeguards, by implementing standards with quality checkpoints. Also, modular workflows or templates to adapt to regulatory change and adjacent transparency requirements.



**Exit criteria**

- Reduced manual effort. Delivery and onboarding need to require substantially less direct involvement from the Compleasy team per customer.
- Quality holds under external delivery, when first IT system integrators successfully implement customers while meeting defined quality and governance checkpoints.
- Proven scalable standards are documented and validated in practice, enabling additional delivery capacity without degrading trust.

**5.5.4 Outcomes & Scaling Readiness**

Across the three phases, Compleasy's go-to-market approach is designed to build from validated customer value to repeatable delivery and finally to enable scalable execution.

By the end of Phase 1, we want to have validated our end-to-end value with three to five co-development customers and to have established a repeatable pilot onboarding approach. In Phase 2, the solution should transition into paid adoption with early adopters, while onboarding and support should become measurable and increasingly standardized toward the target of 20 customers. Phase 3 will consolidate these learnings into a scalable implementation standard to reduce manual effort per customer. In parallel, we will initiate partner outreach and aim to secure the first one to two IT system integrators to validate partner led implementations under controlled conditions.

With this foundation in place, we will be prepared to scale delivery capacity primarily through the expansion of our partner program, supported by standardized onboarding, enablement assets and enforceable quality checkmarks.

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## 6. Management Team

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### 6.1. Organizational Capital and Strategic Composition

The potential for a high-growth start-up like Compleasy to be successful is dependent on the execution capabilities and organizational capital in its team. In the context of the German Mittelstand, where business relationships are built on trust and reliability, the setup of our team is crucial. Our organization is based on the „Upper Echelons Theory“ proposed by Hambrick and Mason. This framework states that organizational outcomes are (partially) predicted by the background characteristics of the management team (Hambrick & Mason, 1984). For a B2B SaaS platform working between legal regulation (LkSG/CSDDD) and rapidly developing artificial intelligence, a homogenous team would be a significant risk known as "groupthink."

To face this, Compleasy has assembled a heterogenous team of nine co-founders. This covers the competencies required for a successful company: domain expertise in compliance law, technical proficiency in AI, and commercial execution. Research by Talke, Salomo, and Kock regarding top management team diversity shows that such functional diversity is connected with strategic innovation, especially when market conditions change quickly (Talke et al., 2011). By covering these functions instead of outsourcing them to consultants, Compleasy secures critical knowledge inside the company. This allows for the development of "Transactive Memory Systems", a psychological phenomenon where team members rely on each other's expertise to solve complex problems faster than a group of generalists would (Wegner, 1987).

### 6.2. Executive Team and Responsibilities

The management structure follows a division designed to optimize speed and accountability. Each member owns a specific risk.

#### **Kamran Ali – Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**

As CEO, Kamran is the architect of the company's vision and the main face towards external stakeholders. His role is defined by the theory of "Dynamic Capabilities," which supports the company's ability to generate opportunities (Teece et al., 1997). In the changing market of compliance, where laws such as the European CSDDD evolve over time, the CEO must be able to adjust the company's strategy without losing momentum. Kamran is responsible for closing the gap between product development and external stakeholders.

His main capability is strategic management and high-level stakeholder management. He leads the overall corporate direction and ensures that the product roadmap aligns with the market. Next, Kamran has the ultimate authority regarding decisions about the MVP. Last, it is his responsibility to establish an open work culture.

#### **Hakim Adams Yakubu – Chief Product Officer (CPO)**

Hakim leads the product strategy including the functional roadmap. His work is defined by the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), which states that the success of a new tool is mainly driven by two factors: Perceived Usefulness and Perceived Ease of Use (Davis, 1989). In the compliance area, software is usually seen as unintuitive and stressful leading to low adoption rates. Hakim's primary job is to work on this by focusing on the user.

His background allows him to design intuitive workflows. This technique presents information to the user only when they need it. Hakim represents the customer within the management team.

### **Lorenz Wenzel – Chief Technology Officer (CTO)**

Lorenz owns the engineering department and software architecture. He is the technical leader of the development team and is responsible for the implementation work. Lorenz makes sure that the engineering team has an agile structure. With code reviews and automated testing the quality of Compleasy is kept at high levels.

### **Johannes Mann – Chief Data Protection Officer (CDPO)**

Johannes serves as the Chief Data Protection Officer (CDPO). He makes sure that the platform complies with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). He establishes the concept of "Data Residency," ensuring that all German client data remains on servers within the DACH region. This is important for the compliance requirements of German SMEs.

### **Qiao Ren – Chief AI Officer**

Qiao is responsible for managing a sustainable and secure AI technology stack. Since Compleasy processes sensitive data, the solution must be scalable. She is responsible for selecting the right AI technology. The most critical piece is the correct integration of Large Language Models (LLMs) to avoid wrong content generation.

### **Anas El Baghdadi – Chief Sustainability Officer (CSO)**

Anas is the legal expert of the team which is unlike other startups where legal advice is purchased as an external service. As CSO, he is the expert for the LkSG and CSDDD. Anas understands legal regulations and works with the CTO on the AI features so that they are based on legal definitions.

### **Beschta Sidiq – Chief Growth Officer (CGO)**

Beschta is responsible for the commercial success of Compleasy. She focuses on the B2B sales and developing strategic partnerships. Her core skills lie in complex sales cycles and negotiation. She ensures that Compleasy's pricing models match with the market demand. She also supports the product teams with feedback from customers. This feedback is important so that the product can evolve and meet customer needs.

### **Rizuanul Kabir – Chief Marketing Officer (CMO)**

Rizuanul owns brand positioning and lead generation. In a market with high information demand, Rizuanul focuses on establishing Compleasy as a competent and reliable solution. Since this is a

knowledge-intensive field, traditional advertising is not effective. Rizuanul will work on white papers, webinars, and guides that advertise Compleasy.

**Marc Wirthmann – Chief Operating Officer (COO)**

Marc drives the operations and finances of Compleasy. While the CEO focuses on the vision, the COO focuses on the usage of resources to create a competitive advantage. He manages the company's metrics like Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) and Lifetime Value (LTV). He also oversees the human resources function, managing the talent attraction and growing the employee base.

## 7. Implementation Plan

This Implementation Plan explains how Compleasy will be built, validate, and operationalize from pre-go-to-market readiness to scalable delivery. The plan is designed to ensure that commercialization is always supported by reliable product outputs, clear governance boundaries in a compliance context, and a delivery model that can grow without linear increases in manual effort.

To achieve this, Compleasy follows a staged implementation logic. Before entering the go-to-market phases, the team completes a pre-go-to-market stage that prepares the product and delivery model for real customer usage. The subsequent phases align directly with the go-to-market roadmap. Q2 2026 focuses on co-development pilots and proof of value, Q3-Q4 2026 transitions into monetization with early adopters and standardizes delivery, and Q1-Q2 2027 prepares the organization for scaling, especially through a partner-led delivery model with IT system integrators. From Q3-Q4 2027 onward, we will start scaling mainly through our partnership programs.

Moreover, to get better structure for the general, funding, legal, compliance, and technical processes that are part of this roadmap, we have created workstreams that describe the tasks we will work on, aligning under the broader go-to-market strategy phases. All those workstreams combined with the go-to-market strategy phases build our Implementation plan.

### 7.1 Implementation KPIs

To track implementation progress from Q1 2026 to Q4 2027, we plan to measure a small set of execution KPIs that reflect delivery speed, product readiness, and output quality. This is just an overview of KPIs we plan to measure, there obviously will be more as they are refined and reviewed continuously. Also, there are of course more topic specific KPIs, such as for example the Customer Acquisition Cost, which are important but rather part of the specific Sales and Marketing KPIs, but not to measure the success of our implementation.

#### Delivery & Onboarding

| KPI                        | Description                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Time-to-first-value (TTFV) | measures the time from project kickoff to the first usable output delivered to the customer, including an initial draft report and a risk overview. |
| Onboarding cycle time      | measures the time from kickoff until the customer can run the workflow independently without hands-on support.                                      |
| Internal delivery effort   | measures the implementation and support hours required to onboard a customer and stabilize usage during the first month.                            |

Figure 6 KPI Descriptions

## Product readiness

| KPI                             | Description                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| End-to-end run success rate     | measures the share of customer cases that complete the full workflow from upload to output without manual workaround or reprocessing. |
| Processing time to first output | measures how long it takes from document upload to the first usable result being available to the user.                               |
| Issue rate                      | measures the number of issues discovered by customers in production that were not detected during internal testing.                   |

Figure 7 Product Readiness KPIs

## Output quality & trust

| KPI                       | Description                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Customer acceptance rate  | measures the share of delivered outputs that customers accept with only minor edits, rather than requiring major rework.             |
| Traceability completeness | measures the share of outputs that include a clear rationale and source references that can be reviewed and used for audit purposes. |

Figure 8 Output Quality KPIs

## 7.2 General Workstreams

### Company foundation (Q1 - Q2 2026)

The goal of this workstream is to incorporate the company and complete core legal and administrative tasks, such as shareholder contracts, creating a banking account and more.

### Corporate design (Q1-Q2 2026)

In this workstream we want to create our corporate design and core brand assets, such as a logo and basic website, to have a professional appearance.

## 7.3 Funding Workstreams

### Funding Preparation (Q1 2026)

We need to prepare fundraising materials like a slide deck, core data and product demos to be ready for our first funding round.

### Pre-seed raise (Q2 2026)

Start outreach to possible investors and attend events to successfully close the pre-seed round to fund the development of the MVP and finance further operations, such as legal certification, compliance readiness, market expansion and partner enablement.

## **7.4 Legal and Compliance workstreams**

### **Validation and Review (Q2-Q4 2026)**

Establish a legal baseline by reviewing templates, risk logic and report structures against relevant requirements and common audit expectations. Our goal is to ensure outputs are transparent and legally sound. To create trust in the product, external validation is important.

### **Continuous Monitoring and Regulatory Updates (Q3 2026 – Q4 2027)**

Continuously maintain legal soundness by reviewing output. This includes quality checks and verification that governance controls function correctly. Follow regulatory changes and incorporate them into the product. This will be increasingly important as the customer base grows and partner-led delivery increases.

## **7.5 Technical workstreams**

### **Development of Pilot-ready product (Q1 2026)**

Deliver a stable end-to-end pilot product with all the core features and a workflow that supports lighthouse pilot customers. The core features include automated document upload and screening, risk analysis, and AI-assisted report generation.

### **Continuous issue fixing and improvements based on feedback loops (Q2 -Q4 2026)**

Based on the feedback of the first pilot customers, resolve issues and implement requested improvements, prioritize bug fixes and reliability enhancements. Build and expand the template baseline so outputs are consistent and usable across first customers.

### **Data protection and access management (Q3-Q4 2026)**

Strengthen data security before scaling by implementing secure storage and role-based access management. Enable customers to define user roles internally so no user can access data without the required permission.

### **Scaling readiness (Q1-Q2 2027)**

Prepare the platform architecture for a larger customer base without risking stability and output quality. Establish scalable operations, including standardized delivery, partnership enablement and quality controls.

### **Continuous improvement of product robustness (Q1 2027 - Q4 2027)**

Further strengthen auditability, monitoring and operational reliability. The objective is to establish overall product robustness, performance and high quality of outputs with a growing customer base and usage.

## **7.6 Go-to market / Sales and marketing workstreams**

This section provides a short overview of the different go-to-market workstreams. Detailed descriptions of the three core phases are in the go-to-market strategy chapter.

### **Development & Preparation | Q1 2026**

Prepare Compleasy to be ready for the pilot phase so co-development can start in Q2 2026 with our first customers. Focus on creating a stable MVP, first templates and a pilot onboarding process with clear governance boundaries.

### **Co-Development & Proof of Value (Pilot Phase) | Q2 2026**

Run pilots with three to five co-development customers in our defined target segment. Acquire them through direct outreach and first industry event participation. Provide the product free of charge in exchange for usage and structured feedback. Monitor usage closely and translate learnings into improvements.

### **Monetization (Early Adopters) | Q3–Q4 2026**

Gain our first paying customers as early adopters while testing standardized delivery. Offer high discounts with an average of 50%, with the goal of reaching our first 20 customers by the end of the year. Refine and improve onboarding into a repeatable and scalable format.

### **Scale Preparation & First Partners | Q1 - Q2 2027**

Consolidate an implementation standard that is ready for scaling. Start reaching out for our first partners, with a focus on IT system integrators to validate partner-led delivery and support. To attract partners, we offer attractive incentives such as high margins and free onboarding.

### **Scaling with focus on Partnership Program | Q3 - Q4 2027**

Expand the IT system integrator network and shift the delivery, onboarding and support to our partners. Operate a structure certification and quality model. From this point onward, we want to primarily scale through our partners, while direct sales become less important.



Figure 9 Implementation Plan

| Workstream                         | 2026                |                                                            |                                              |    | 2027                                         |    |                                           |    |
|------------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|----|----------------------------------------------|----|-------------------------------------------|----|
|                                    | Q1                  | Q2                                                         | Q3                                           | Q4 | Q1                                           | Q2 | Q3                                        | Q4 |
| General                            | Company foundation  |                                                            |                                              |    |                                              |    |                                           |    |
|                                    |                     | Corporate design                                           |                                              |    |                                              |    |                                           |    |
| Funding                            | Funding Preparation | Pre-seed raise                                             |                                              |    |                                              |    |                                           |    |
| Legal and Compliance               |                     | Validation and Review                                      |                                              |    |                                              |    |                                           |    |
|                                    |                     |                                                            | Continuous Monitoring and Regulatory Updates |    |                                              |    |                                           |    |
| Technical                          | Pilot-ready product | Continuous issue fixing and improvements based on feedback |                                              |    | Scaling readiness                            |    |                                           |    |
|                                    |                     |                                                            | Data protection and access management        |    | Continuous improvement of product robustness |    |                                           |    |
| Go-to-Market / Sales and Marketing | Preparation         | Co-Development & Proof of Value (Pilot Phase)              | Monetization (Early Adopters)                |    | Scale Preparation and First Partners         |    | Scaling with focus on partnership program |    |

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## 8. Critical Risks

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The market entry and long-term operation of an AI-driven compliance solution such as Compleasy are inseparably linked to a complex risk landscape. In an environment characterized by highly dynamic legislation, rapid technological change, and geopolitical instability, the quality of risk management becomes a decisive factor for the resilience of the business model. The following section analyzes the critical risk domains, regulatory, technological, and market-related, and outlines the corresponding mitigation strategies.

### 8.1 Regulatory Dynamics and the “Moving Target” Risk

The primary risk to the Compleasy business model arises from its dependence on national and international legislative processes. Since the product is designed as a solution for specific due diligence obligations (such as the German Supply Chain Due Diligence Act (LkSG) or the forthcoming Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD)), political decisions have a direct and immediate impact on demand dynamics.

A recent and illustrative example of this volatility is the decision by the Federal Office for Economic Affairs and Export Control (BAFA) to temporarily suspend or relax the enforcement of reporting obligations under the LkSG in anticipation of the upcoming EU directive (CSDDD). (Bundesamt für Wirtschaft und Ausfuhrkontrolle [BAFA], 2025)

For a company in the market entry phase, this creates the risk of a “wait-and-see” attitude among potential customers. Firms may postpone the implementation of compliance software, as the immediate sanction pressure associated with public reporting requirements appears temporarily reduced.

Compleasy addresses this risk through strategic repositioning. Rather than positioning the product as an isolated reporting tool, it is defined as a comprehensive operational risk management system. The legal duty of care, namely, the obligation to conduct risk analyses and implement preventive measures, remains in force regardless of the suspension of a specific reporting format. Our communication strategy emphasizes to customers that the current regulatory breathing space represents an ideal opportunity to establish robust digital processes before the significantly stricter CSDDD, with its far-reaching liability provisions, comes into effect. (Poerting, 2024) On a technological level, this strategy is supported by a modular system architecture that allows new regulatory requirements to be implemented via updates without disrupting core processes. Moreover, this way, we will have flexibility and can pivot ourselves to become a player in the compliance and advisory sector tackling various regulatory fields, such as ESG advisory. As a result, regulatory uncertainty is transformed into a competitive advantage based on agility.

## 8.2 Technological Integrity: AI Validity and Quality Assurance

As an AI-centric product, Compleasy operates at the intersection of technological innovation and legal accountability. This positioning entails the risk of technical failure, particularly in the context of Large Language Models (LLMs). The phenomenon of "AI hallucinations", the generation of factually incorrect information, constitutes an existential threat in the compliance domain, as misinterpretations of documents may expose customers to legal risks. (Dahl et al., 2024)

To address this challenge, Compleasy leverages intelligent Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) architectures to technically minimize the probability of error. However, fully aware that no purely technical solution can completely negate this risk at this point, the company follows a robust dual strategy combining operational control and external certification. At its core lies the "human-in-the-loop" principle, under which AI functions as a highly efficient co-pilot. While the system performs data pre-structuring and initial assessments, it does not make uncontrolled final decisions. All analytical results are presented transparently to users, including source references and confidence indicators, ensuring that the compliance officer always retains ultimate interpretative authority.

In addition to human oversight, Compleasy emphasizes measurable quality through external validation. Rather than relying exclusively on internal testing, the solution is subjected to continuous audits by independent certification bodies such as TÜV. In particular, the company aims to achieve certification under ISO/IEC 42001 for transparent AI management systems (International Organization for Standardization [ISO], 2023), as well as verification in accordance with IDW PS 880 to formally confirm the software's compliance, reliability, and auditability from the perspective of statutory auditors. (Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer in Deutschland [IDW], 2010) Through this combination of advanced RAG technology, human control, and audited quality standards, technological risks are transformed into a robust and credible security promise.

## 8.3 Data Sovereignty and Trust Risks in a Cross-Border Context

Supply chain compliance involves the processing of highly sensitive data that touches the very core of an organization: supplier relationships, pricing structures, and internal audit results. Consequently, the risk of unauthorized data access or violations of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) must be considered critical. The use of US-based cloud services, in particular, represents a legal risk for European companies. Under the US Cloud Act, American authorities may theoretically request access to data even when it is stored on servers located within Europe, provided the service provider is a US-based company. (European Data Protection Board [EDPB] & European Data Protection Supervisor [EDPS], 2019)

Beyond legal considerations, increasing political tensions and geopolitical uncertainty further amplify this risk. Unpredictability in future trade and data protection policies between the United States and Europe has led many companies to actively seek domestic solutions in order to protect themselves against sudden regulatory disruptions or transatlantic data conflicts. Compleasy

addresses this challenge through its “Trust Promise” of data residency, based on consistent hosting on German infrastructure providers (e.g., StackIT). By deliberately excluding US-based infrastructure from core processes, Compleasy guarantees full digital sovereignty and offers customers a long-term, politically independent solution that is resilient to extraterritorial access risks.

#### **8.4 Competition and Market Consolidation**

Finally, Compleasy faces market risk arising from the potential entry of large ERP providers, such as SAP or Oracle, into the compliance software segment for SMEs. These companies possess substantial financial resources and benefit from deep integration into customers’ existing system landscapes.

This displacement risk is countered through specialization and speed. While large ERP solutions are often complex, costly, and slow to implement (Trovarit AG, 2024), Compleasy offers a lean solution that can be deployed within days through a zero-integration approach. The company deliberately targets the upper mid-market, which requires a flexible, affordable, and legally focused solution that does not depend on multi-year IT transformation projects. In this context, risk is mitigated through clear positioning as a best-of-breed solution rather than a monolithic platform.

#### **8.5 SWOT Analysis**

The detailed analysis of regulatory, technological, and market-related risk domains culminates in a holistic evaluation of Compleasy’s strategic position. While the inherent risks of an AI-driven business model in a volatile legislative environment are significant, a systematic assessment reveals that the company’s internal capabilities are specifically aligned to neutralize these external threats. The following SWOT analysis synthesizes these factors, contrasting the company’s agile technological foundation against the inertia of established market players. This overview serves not merely as a status quo assessment, but as the structural logic guiding the company’s go-to-market strategy.

Compleasy | SWOT Profile



Figure 8: Strategic SWOT profile of Compleasy

The juxtaposition of these factors highlights a clear strategic advantage: Compleasy effectively converts industry-wide threats into specific opportunities.

Most notably, the threat of market consolidation by ERP giants (such as SAP or Oracle) is countered by the company’s distinct "Best-of-Breed" specialization and Zero-Integration capability. Where incumbents struggle with slow implementation cycles and legacy complexity, compleasy leverages its lean architecture to capture the "Mid-Market Gap" immediately, often before larger competitors can mobilize their sales force.

Furthermore, the risk of regulatory volatility (as seen with the BAFA decisions) is mitigated by the platform’s technological agility. Unlike rigid monolithic systems, the modular RAG architecture allows for rapid adaptation to new legal frameworks, turning regulatory shifts from a disruption into a retention driver. Finally, the "Trust Promise" regarding data sovereignty (StackIT) serves as a decisive immune system against geopolitical data risks, creating a defensible moat around European customers that US-based competitors cannot easily cross. In conclusion, the analysis confirms that Compleasy is positioned not to avoid risk, but to manage it with superior agility and focus.

**9. Financial Projections and Analysis**

Compleasy's financial model demonstrates a capital-efficient path to profitability, requiring only €290,000 in external funding to build a business generating €9.4 million in revenue by 2032. The company achieves EBITDA profitability in Year 3 (2028) and accumulates €9.7 million in cash by 2032, with exceptional unit economics driven by 97%+ gross margins, efficient partner-based distribution, and strong customer retention.

**9.1. Funding Requirements and Capital Structure**

**9.1.1. Startup Capital**

Compleasy requires €63,480 in startup capital to establish operations in Q2 2026. This comprises €1,480 for legal setup (GmbH notary fees, commercial register, business registration), €12,500 for mandatory share capital deposit (50% of €25,000 minimum), and €49,500 for MVP development including cloud infrastructure, AI processing capabilities, UI/UX design, QA/security testing, and a senior software engineer for three months.

**9.1.2. Total External Funding**

The company raises €290,000 in equity through a pre-seed round covering startup costs, initial working capital, and to fund operations through profitability. This represents the total external capital required - no additional fundraising is needed through 2032. The company operates debt-free throughout the forecast period, eliminating financial risk and preserving founder control.

| Funding Component             | Amount (€)     | Timing      |
|-------------------------------|----------------|-------------|
| Startup Costs (Legal + MVP)   | 63,480         | 2026 Q2     |
| Pre-Seed Equity               | 290,000        | 2026 Q2     |
| <b>Total External Funding</b> | <b>290,000</b> | <b>2026</b> |

Table 4 Funding and Startup Costs

**9.2. Revenue Model and Growth Trajectory**

**9.2.1. Market Foundation**

The addressable market begins with 45,000 German SMEs subject to CSRD regulations including LkSG and CSDDD, growing 2% annually. This growth assumption is conservative given German GDP forecasts of 1.0-1.8% for 2026-2027 and accounts for both business formation and expanding regulatory scope. Approximately 70% of affected SMEs (31,500 companies) are estimated to be

unprepared for compliance in 2026, declining to 65% by 2032 as market education improves. Compleasy targets 10% of this unprepared segment initially, scaling to 40% by 2032 as distribution partnerships mature.

### 9.2.2. Pricing and Customer Segmentation

The platform offers tiered pricing based on supplier complexity: Starter (€3,600/year for up to 50 suppliers), Small (€8,900/year for up to 300 suppliers), Medium (€18,900/year for up to 1,500 suppliers), and Large (€45,000/year for extensive requirements)<sup>1</sup>. Prices increase 2% annually to match inflation. This pricing structure reflects industry norms for compliance software in the European market, where solutions targeting SMEs command €15–70 per user per month with annual price increases of 8–30% as regulatory risk premiums rise. The customer mix is estimated at 35% Starter, 35% Small, 25% Medium, and 5% Large, reflecting the SME-focused market. To accelerate adoption, the company offers steep initial discounts (40% in 2026) that decline to 2% by 2030 as brand recognition builds.

### 9.2.3. Customer Acquisition Strategy

Customer acquisition leverages three key advantages. First, the nine co-founders do the cold outreach and word-of-mouth marketing for initial customer development. Second, a partner-driven distribution strategy through consultants and system integrators scales outreach beyond direct sales capacity. Partners contribute 0% of customers in 2026 (direct sales only) but grow to 30-35% by 2032. Third, reference customers and case studies progressively reduce sales friction. Within each segment, Compleasy applies segment-specific conversion rates that increase over time, reflecting both product maturation and market education. Starter entities convert at 0.7% of the reachable market in 2026, ramping to 6% by 2032; Small entities at 0.7%–6%; Medium at 0.5%–7%; Large at 0%–4%. These conversion rates are conservative relative

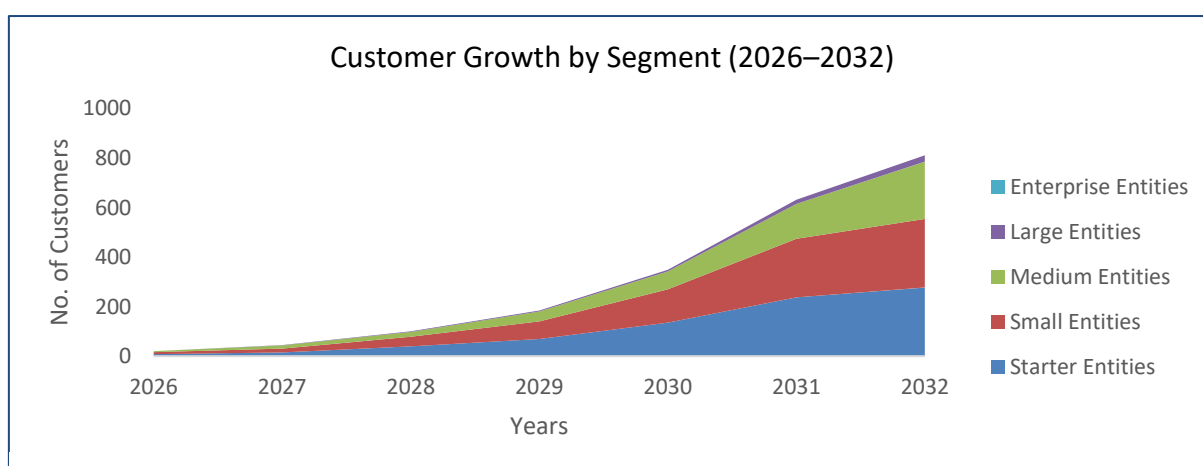


Figure 10 Customer Growth (YoY)

<sup>1</sup> <https://www.dialectica.io/blog/navigating-the-european-tax-accounting-software-landscape-trends-and-compliance-challenges-for-smes>

to B2B SaaS benchmarks and are justified by regulatory urgency: while typical B2B SaaS solutions average 1–5% lead-to-customer conversion, compliance and regulatory technology solutions benefit from 2–3x higher conversion rates due to regulatory deadlines and mandatory adoption timelines that collapse sales cycles and reduce customer acquisition friction.<sup>234</sup> The assumption that conversion rates increase substantially over time reflects learning effects (Compleasy builds case studies and best practices), expanded sales capacity (team grows from 0 to 3 sales executives by 2029), and improving product-market fit.

#### 9.2.4. ESG Advisory Revenue Stream

Beginning in 2028, Compleasy introduces ESG advisory services as an upsell to existing customers. This addresses two strategic objectives: providing deeper consulting support that customers need beyond software tools, and diversifying revenue to mitigate regulatory risk if LkSG/CSDDD requirements change. ESG Advisory is priced as tiered annual retainers: €2,500 for Starter customers, €5,000 for Small, €10,000 for Medium, and €20,000 for Large entities. This structure mirrors premium advisory pricing in the European compliance consulting market, where specialized ESG guidance commands 20–40% premiums above base platform fees.<sup>5</sup> Adoption of advisory services ramps gradually, with only 5–10% of customers uptaking services in 2028 (generating €25k total advisory revenue), accelerating to 15–30% adoption by 2032 (generating €1.32m), yielding incremental ARPU of €1.3–4.3k per customer by the end of the forecast period. The combination of subscription and advisory revenue positions Compleasy as both a technology and services provider, diversifying revenue streams and improving customer lifetime value.

#### 9.2.5. Revenue Projections (in €k)

| Year                    | 2026      | 2027       | 2028       | 2029        | 2030        | 2031        | 2032        |
|-------------------------|-----------|------------|------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| Subscription            | 176       | 497        | 989        | 1922        | 3641        | 7058        | 10134       |
| ESG Advisory            | 0         | 0          | 25         | 93          | 405         | 835         | 1320        |
| Discounts               | -58       | -106       | -89        | -87         | -70         | -137        | -193        |
| <b>Net Revenue (€k)</b> | <b>87</b> | <b>318</b> | <b>798</b> | <b>1660</b> | <b>3440</b> | <b>6709</b> | <b>9437</b> |

<sup>2</sup> <https://callin.io/b2b-saas-marketing-benchmarks/>

<sup>3</sup> <https://adamfard.com/blog/b2b-saas-benchmarks>

<sup>4</sup> <https://www.leanlabs.com/blog/b2b-saas-conversion-rate-benchmarks>

<sup>5</sup> <https://www.dialectica.io/blog/navigating-the-european-tax-accounting-software-landscape-trends-and-compliance-challenges-for-smes>



|            |   |      |      |      |      |     |     |
|------------|---|------|------|------|------|-----|-----|
| YoY Growth | — | 267% | 151% | 108% | 107% | 95% | 41% |
|------------|---|------|------|------|------|-----|-----|

Table 5 Revenue Projections

## 9.3 Cost Structure and Unit Economics

### 9.3.1 Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)

COGS consists of AI document processing (€0.11 per page via Google Cloud Document AI) and cloud infrastructure (StackIT for German data residency)<sup>6</sup>. Based on estimated document volumes of 1,500-8,000 pages per customer depending on tier, AI costs grow from €4,015 in 2026 to €193,490 in 2032. Cloud services scale from €10,000 to €30,000 annually. Total COGS increases from €14,015 to €223,490, but gross margin improves from 84% to 98% as revenue scales faster than variable costs. This exceptional margin profile reflects the capital-light SaaS model and AI automation advantages.

### 9.3.2. Operating Expenses

**Variable Operating Costs:** Marketing expenses begin at €15,000 and grow 40% in 2027, declining to 15% growth by 2032 as brand recognition builds, reaching €127,150. Partner commissions are critical to the distribution strategy, set at 25% of revenue for partner-sourced deals (declining to 20% from 2029 onward), growing from zero to €200,412 as partner contribution scales from 0% to 30-35% of customers. Sales travel (€7,500 growing at 20% annually) and customer support (€100 per customer) complete variable costs.

**Fixed Operating Costs:** Legal advisory is essential for a compliance platform, budgeted at €150,000 in 2026 scaling to €400,000 by 2032 to ensure platform recommendations stay current with evolving regulations. Office rent begins at zero (remote-first) and increases to €80,000 from 2030 as team expands. Administrative expenses range from €10,000 to €40,000 annually.

### 9.3.3. Personnel Strategy

The nine co-founders (CEO, CPO, CTO, CDPO, CAIO, CSO, CGO, CMO, and COO) defer salaries entirely from 2026-2028 to minimize burn rate and extend runway. This founder sacrifice is critical to achieving profitability on limited capital. Salaries begin in 2029 at modest levels (€40,000-€45,000 depending on role) and scale to €75,000-€100,000 by 2032. Non-founder hires are added strategically: one senior software engineer in 2026 (€100,000 + 20% social costs), scaling to three by 2028. Sales executives join in 2029 (growing to four by 2032 at €40,000 each), and ESG consultants start in 2029 (growing to four by 2031 at €60,000 each) to support advisory

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revenue. Total headcount grows from 10 to 20, with salary costs increasing from €60,000 (2026 Q3 and 2026 Q4) to €1.81 million in 2032.

## 9.4. Path to Profitability and Cash Generation

### 9.4.1. EBITDA and Operating Leverage

Compleasy achieves EBITDA profitability in 2028 (Year 3), just two years after launch. EBITDA progresses from -€92k (2026) and -€90k (2027) to +€159k (2028), then accelerates to €6.43 million by 2032. EBITDA margins expand from -106% to 68%, driven by operating leverage as fixed costs are absorbed by growing revenue. The margin jump from 10% (2029) to 43% (2030) coincides with founders drawing salaries, yet the business remains highly profitable—demonstrating strong underlying unit economics.

### 9.4.2. Net Income and Cumulative Profitability

Net income turns positive in 2028 at €123k (after 15% corporate tax and €14-21k annual depreciation) and reaches €5.45 million by 2032. Cumulative retained earnings turn positive in Q3 2029, meaning all initial losses are recovered within three years. By 2032, retained earnings total €10.19 million, transforming the balance sheet from startup to strongly capitalized business. Net margins reach 58% by 2032, exceptional for any industry.

This chart shows quarterly profit/loss and cumulative retained earnings from 2026 Q2 through 2032 Q4.

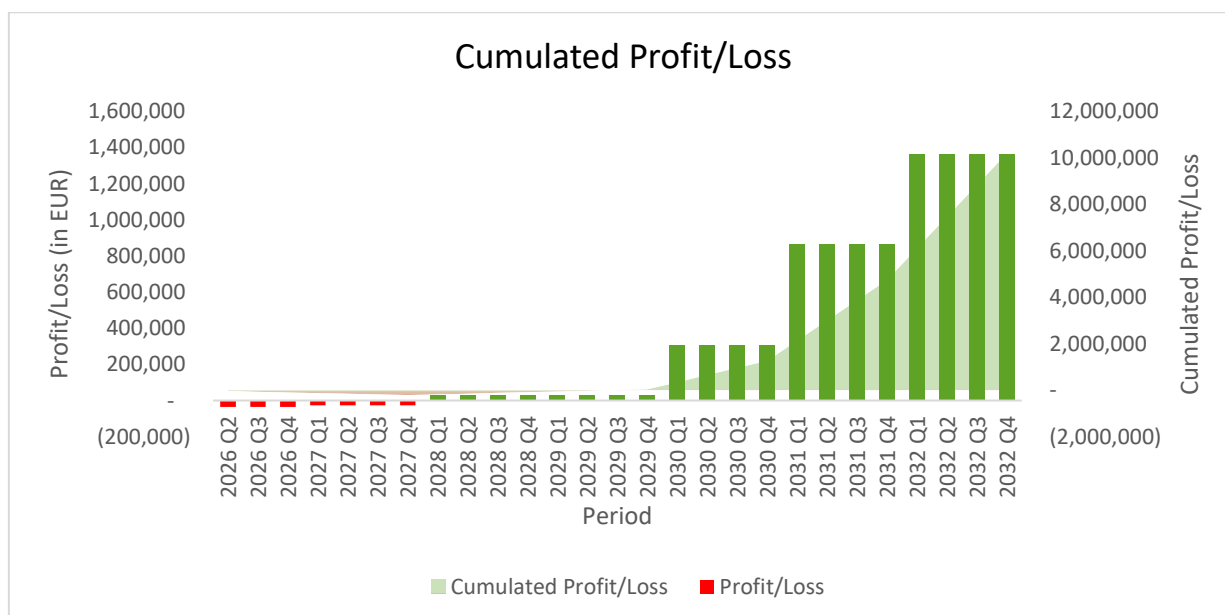


Figure 11 Cumulated Profit and Loss Chart

### 9.4.3. Cash Flow and Balance Sheet Strength

Operating cash flow turns positive in 2028 at €101k and grows to €5.25 million by 2032. Working capital assumptions are standard for B2B SaaS: 30-day accounts receivable, minimal inventory, and 60-day accounts payable in 2026 (improving to 30 days by 2029 to build supplier goodwill). Capital expenditures remain minimal (€65k in 2026 for MVP, then €3-30k annually for office equipment), reflecting the cloud-based model. Cash balance declines from the initial €290k raise to €26k by end of 2027, then rebuilds to €124k (2028), €182k (2029), €1.28 million (2030), €4.48 million (2031), and €9.71 million by 2032. The company requires no additional funding after the 2026 pre seed round.

## 9.5. Critical Assumptions and Justifications

### 9.5.1. Customer Retention and Churn

Annual churn rates are assumed at 15% (2026), 10% (2027), and 7% (2028 onward). These are conservative and well-grounded in industry benchmarks. Research indicates early-stage B2B SaaS companies serving SMEs typically experience 10-15% annual churn initially, declining to 5-7% as product-market fit strengthens and switching costs increase. For platforms with ARPA in the €3,600-€45,000 range (Compleasy's pricing), 5-7% is the target steady-state churn. Our 7% assumption aligns with realistic expectations. Compliance software exhibits particularly strong retention due to high switching costs (re-uploading data, retraining staff, disrupting audit trails) and sustained regulatory demand.<sup>78</sup>

### 9.5.2. Partner Economics

Partner commission rates of 25% (declining to 20% from 2029) align with standard B2B SaaS reseller programs. Industry research shows typical SaaS reseller commissions range from 10-35%, with 25-40% common for partner-closed deals. Our rates are competitive for early partnerships while declining as brand pull strengthens. The assumption that partners contribute 0% of customers initially (2026) and scale to 30-35% by 2032 reflects realistic partnership maturation timelines—partners need time to learn the product, build pipeline, and close deals.<sup>9</sup>

### 9.5.3. Market Growth and Pricing

The 2% annual SME growth rate is conservative given German economic forecasts. Major institutions project German GDP growth of 0.8-1.5% for 2026 and 1.1-1.8% for 2027<sup>10</sup>, with continued moderate growth thereafter as infrastructure spending takes effect. Our 2% SME growth assumption accounts for both organic business formation and expanding regulatory scope

<sup>7</sup> <https://www.vitality.io/post/saas-churn-benchmarks>

<sup>8</sup> <https://www.hubifi.com/blog/calculate-saas-churn-rate>

<sup>9</sup> <https://saaslucid.com/saas-reseller-commission/>

<sup>10</sup> <https://www.reuters.com/world/europe/german-government-cuts-2026-2027-growth-forecasts-due-rising-uncertainty-2026-01-28/>

bringing additional companies into compliance requirements. The 2% annual price increase matches projected German inflation of 2.1-2.3%<sup>11</sup> through the forecast period.

## 9.6. Unit Economics and SaaS Metrics

### 9.6.1. Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) and Payback

In 2026, total sales and marketing expenses (€22.5k) divided by 20 new customers yields a blended CAC of €1,125. However, with 40% discounting, effective first-year revenue per customer is approximately €2,596, and gross profit per customer is €2,336 (90% margin). CAC payback is therefore approximately 12 months—acceptable for B2B SaaS. By 2032, CAC declines to ~€1,050 while average revenue per customer increases to €11,600 (with only 2% discounting), creating a payback period of approximately 1.1 months and demonstrating exceptional mature-stage unit economics.

### 9.6.2. Rule of 40 Performance

The Rule of 40 (growth rate + profit margin  $\geq$  40%) is a key SaaS benchmark. Compleasy exceeds this in every year from 2028 onward. In 2028, revenue growth is 151% and EBITDA margin is 20%, yielding a score of 171%. By 2032, growth moderates to 27% but EBITDA margin reaches 68%, yielding a score of 95%. This consistently strong performance demonstrates that Compleasy achieves both growth and profitability simultaneously - a rare combination indicating exceptional business quality.

## 9.7. Sensitivity Analysis and Risk Mitigation

### 9.7.1. Customer Acquisition Risk

If conversion rates fall 30% short in 2026-2027 (acquiring 14 customers instead of 20 in year one), profitability is delayed by approximately one quarter but still achieved in 2028. The €290,000 seed capital provides sufficient runway to reach breakeven even with slower traction. The nine co-founders' extensive networks and willingness to defer salaries provide significant cushion against acquisition challenges.

### 9.7.2. Pricing Pressure

If discounts must remain at 15% through 2030 (versus declining to 2% as modeled), revenue in 2030 would decline by approximately €450k. This delays some profitability targets by approximately six months but does not prevent achieving breakeven in 2028. The strong gross margins provide cushion to absorb pricing pressure while maintaining positive unit economics.

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<sup>11</sup> <https://tradingeconomics.com/germany/inflation-cpi>

### 9.7.3. Churn Impact

If steady-state churn increases from 7% to 10% (still within acceptable B2B SaaS ranges), the 2032 customer base would decline from 811 to approximately 720, reducing revenue by roughly 11%. However, EBITDA margin would still exceed 50% due to strong gross margins and operational leverage, maintaining solid profitability and attractive unit economics.

### 9.7.4. Regulatory Risk Mitigation

The ESG advisory revenue stream directly addresses regulatory risk. If LkSG or CSDDD requirements weaken, the consulting business remains valuable as companies still need supply chain due diligence expertise for other reasons (investor pressure, customer requirements, reputational risk). The €150k-€400k annual legal advisory budget ensures the platform adapts to regulatory changes rather than becoming obsolete. Additionally, diversification into adjacent compliance areas (CSRD, EU Taxonomy) provides further risk mitigation.

## 9.8. Financial Conclusion and Investment Thesis

Compleasy demonstrates exceptional financial characteristics across multiple dimensions. The company requires minimal external capital (€290,000 total, no additional funding needed), achieves rapid profitability (EBITDA positive in Year 3), generates strong cash flow (€9.7 million by 2032), maintains zero debt throughout the forecast period, delivers exceptional unit economics, and provides revenue diversification through ESG advisory services mitigating regulatory risk.

The business model's capital efficiency is remarkable: €290,000 in external funding generates €9.4 million in annual revenue by 2032, a 32.5x capital efficiency ratio. By Year 7, the company accumulates €10.2 million in retained earnings and €9.7 million in cash, transforming from startup to strongly capitalized business without dilutive fundraising rounds. This is achieved through founder sacrifice (salary deferrals 2026-2028), partner-driven distribution reducing CAC, AI automation creating operating leverage, and disciplined cost management throughout the scaling journey.

All key assumptions are grounded in extensive industry research and conservative where appropriate. Churn rates align with B2B SaaS benchmarks for SME-focused platforms. Partner economics match standard reseller programs. Market growth assumptions are conservative relative to economic forecasts. Conversion rates reflect realistic expectations for a nine-person founding team. The sensitivity analysis demonstrates resilience to adverse scenarios across customer acquisition, pricing, churn, and regulatory dimensions.

In conclusion, Compleasy presents a compelling financial proposition: solving a critical compliance challenge for 31,500+ German SMEs with a capital-efficient, highly profitable, and scalable SaaS business model that achieves both rapid growth and strong profitability—a rare combination demonstrating exceptional business quality and sustainable competitive advantage.

## 9.9. Valuation Methodology

A discounted cash flow (DCF) analysis values Compleasy based on the present value of its projected future cash flows discounted at a 20% cost of capital (reflecting the risk profile of an early-stage venture) and a 10x terminal EBITDA multiple applied to 2032 EBITDA (€6.42m), yielding a terminal value of €64.2m. The present value of this terminal value, discounted at 20% over 7 years, is €17.9m. Combined with the NPV of near-term cash flows (€2.4m), the total enterprise value is approximately €20.8m, corresponding to an implied EV/revenue multiple of 46.8x on 2027 revenue. This multiple appears elevated on first glance but is justified for an early-stage SaaS company: at 2027 revenue of only €424k, the valuation reflects not current revenue but rather the expected high-growth trajectory and 66% EBITDA margins at maturity. As the company scales and approaches €10m revenue by 2032, the EV/revenue multiple will compress significantly (approaching 2–3x, typical for mature SaaS), reflecting normalized growth and maturity multiples. For the terminal value, we have applied a 10x EBITDA multiple to 2032 EBITDA. This sits at the low end of the observed range for mature, profitable SaaS and RegTech businesses, which are commonly valued at 10–15x EBITDA and often above 20x for high-growth, high-margin companies. Given Compleasy's projected EBITDA margin of 66% and recurring, compliance-driven revenue model, a tech-style multiple is appropriate. We deliberately choose 10x - rather than the 12–20x<sup>12</sup> seen in many private SaaS transactions - to incorporate a discount for execution, size, and market risk and to remain conservative in an academic setting. However, in our pre-seed ask, we will offer 15% of equity to raise €290,000 and deviate from our current valuation because we realise that we are a pre-revenue startup, so the investing party have a big risk.

## 9.10. Financial Summary

| Metric           | 2026 | 2027 | 2028 | 2029 | 2030 | 2031 | 2032 |
|------------------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| Customers        | 20   | 45   | 100  | 184  | 349  | 632  | 811  |
| Net Revenue (€k) | 87   | 318  | 798  | 1660 | 3440 | 6709 | 9437 |
| Gross Margin %   | 84%  | 92%  | 95%  | 96%  | 97%  | 97%  | 98%  |
| EBITDA (€k)      | -92  | -90  | 159  | 163  | 1469 | 4095 | 6428 |
| Headcount        | 10   | 10   | 11   | 14   | 16   | 19   | 20   |
| Net Income (€k)  | -105 | -104 | 123  | 124  | 1231 | 3469 | 5449 |

<sup>12</sup> <https://www.viaductus.de/en-US/knowledge/topics/it-services/multiples>

|                   |     |    |     |     |      |      |      |
|-------------------|-----|----|-----|-----|------|------|------|
| Cash Balance (€k) | 132 | 26 | 124 | 182 | 1281 | 4485 | 9711 |
|-------------------|-----|----|-----|-----|------|------|------|

Table 6 Complete Financial Summary

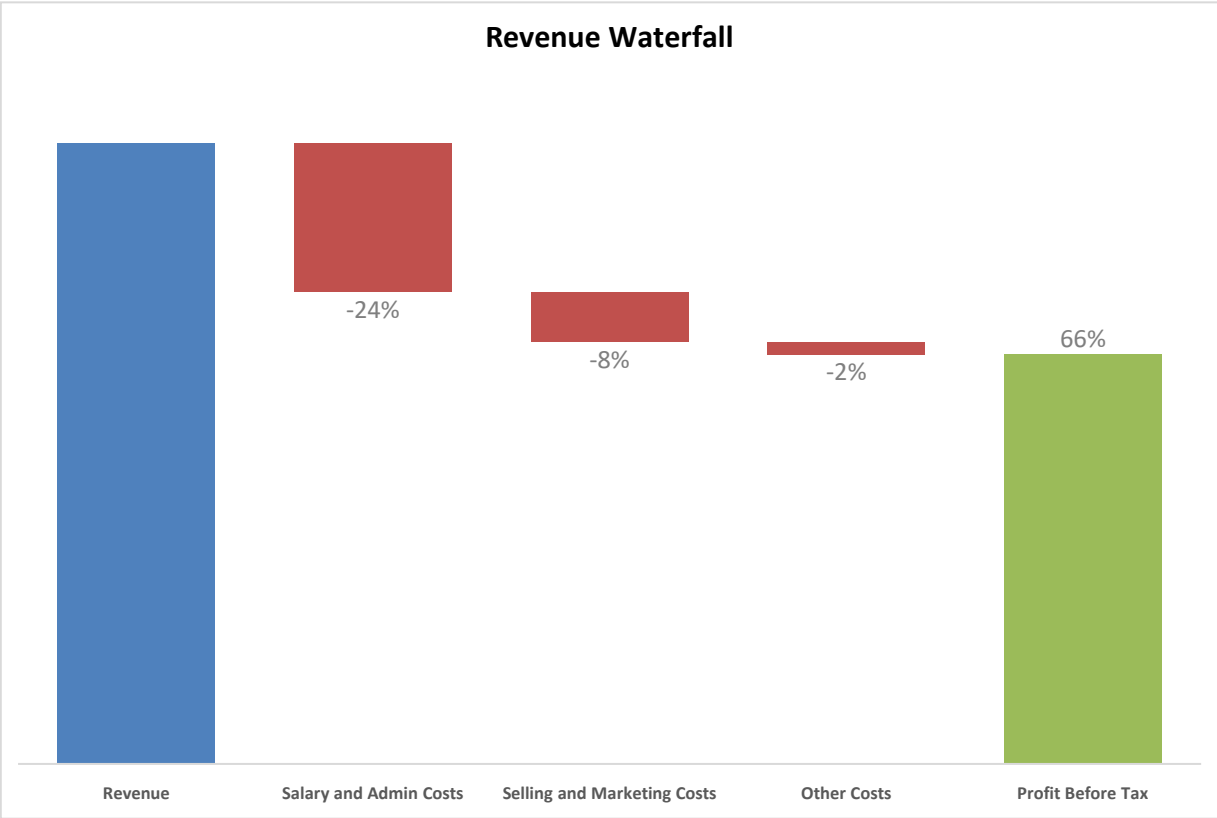


Figure 12 Revenue Waterfall

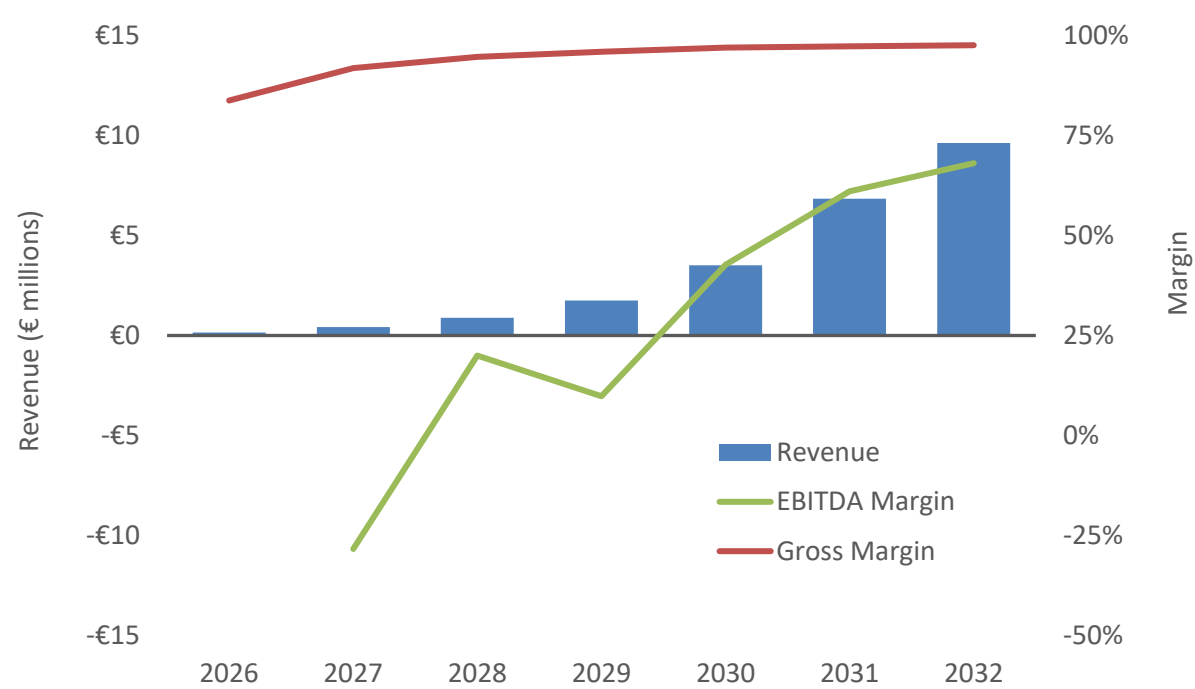


Figure 14 Unit Economics

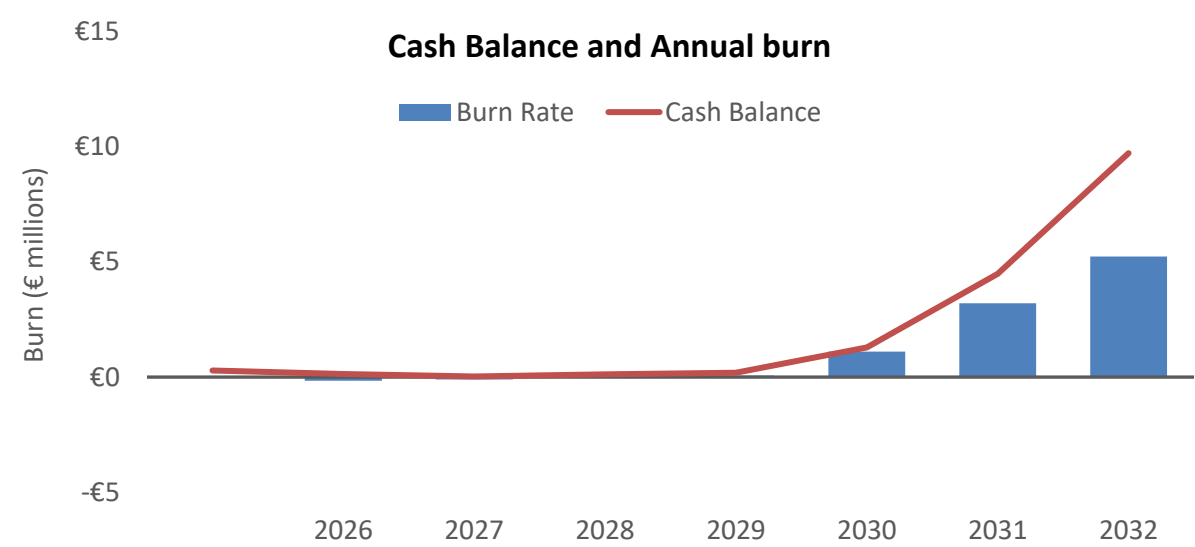


Figure 13 Cash Balance and Burn Rate Overtime



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## 10. Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

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### 10.1. Philosophy and Scope

The development of the MVP follows the “Design Science Research” (DSR) methodology, which focuses on the creation and evaluation of IT artifacts to tackle organizational problems (Hevner et al., 2004). We decided against the Waterfall approach of building a massive and feature-complete software suite before validating anything. Instead, we want to include feedback throughout the full development process. This minimizes the risk of building unnecessary features.

The MVP is designed as a fully working application rather than a simple collection of static images. It focuses on the features identified during our research. These are the critical activities that users must perform to achieve their goals: supplier management, automated document analysis and legal reporting. Any other feature will be moved to future releases. This prioritization helps us to enter the market quickly, collect more data, and improve the product quickly.

### 10.2. Technical Architecture and Security

To meet the rigorous standards of the German compliance market, the MVP is built on a modular, type-safe, and scalable architecture. For Frontend & Usability, we utilize a responsive Single Page Application (SPA) approach using TypeScript and Tailwind CSS to ensure seamless performance across both desktop monitors for deep work and tablet devices for on-site audits. This foundation relies on React, which maintains its status as a premier industry standard, consistently ranking as the most widely adopted library for building user interfaces among professional developers. (Stack Overflow, 2025)

The Backend & Infrastructure relies on a specialized architecture to support the widespread integration of AI across our core components. Due to the vast amount of unstructured data in supply chain documents, we implement a RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) system. This system pre-selects relevant data chunks before processing, significantly reducing the context load on our AI models aiming to lower hallucination. To host this RAG infrastructure and ensure strict data residency, we utilize Microsoft Azure services with resources located specifically in Sweden (EU). This ensures full GDPR compliance and sustainability standards. For the generation layer, our AI capabilities are powered by a multi-model approach using various Google Gemini models, optimizing for speed (Flash) and complex legal reasoning (Pro). While the current setup guarantees that data never leaves the European Union, the long-term roadmap entails a migration to a certified German cloud provider to satisfy the specific data residency preferences of the German Mittelstand.

### 10.3. Core Components

The MVP is structured into four high-impact modules, covering the entire compliance lifecycle from data collection to legal reporting. Each module is designed to maximize intuitiveness and user trust.

To demonstrate the operational value and logical flow of these components, the following overview visualizes the interface through the lens of Lukas Müller, our archetypal target user (Head of Compliance at HQ, a German SME).

10.3. Core Components

10.3.1. Supplier Management

The foundation of the platform is the Supplier Registry. While many SMEs currently manage critical supply chain data using fragmented legacy tools like Excel, our MVP replaces this manual overhead with a centralized, modern database.

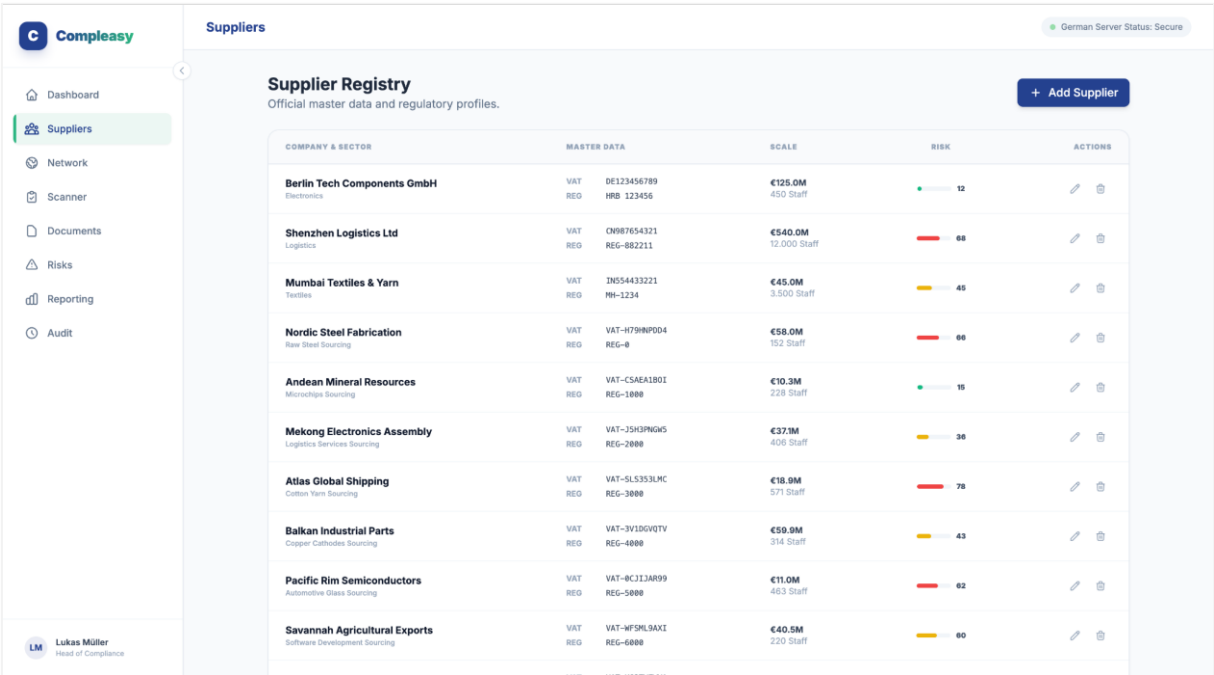


Figure 15 Supplier Overview

As shown in this registry view, Lukas gains immediate access to structured master data. This overview is vital for Lukas to navigate the specific legal liability standards required by the LkSG, ensuring he focuses his auditing efforts where the law demands it most.

To move beyond abstract data rows, the MVP includes a 3D Network Visualization.



Figure 16 Global Supplier Network

Lukas utilizes this interactive globe to visually interpret supply chain risks in a spatial context. Instead of searching through lists, he can instantly identify regional risk clusters, such as the high-risk node in Shenzhen shown in the example, allowing for a faster, more intuitive assessment of global vulnerabilities.

10.3.2. AI Document Scanner

Leveraging the RAG architecture described in the technical section, the AI Document Scanner serves as the efficiency engine of the platform. This module solves the "information overload" problem by automatically extracting structured risk data from unstructured PDF audit reports.

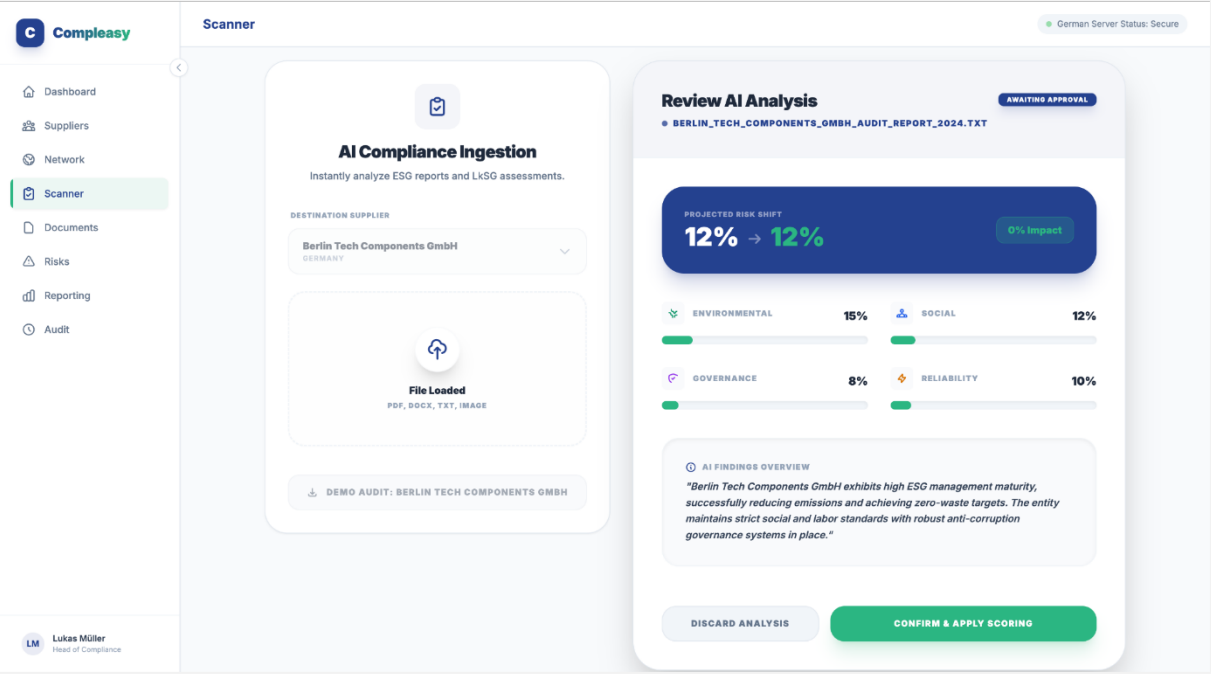


Figure 17 Document Scanner Overview

In the workflow depicted above, Lukas has uploaded an audit report for Berlin Tech Components GmbH. Instead of manually parsing hundreds of pages, the system presents him with an instant "Review AI Analysis" dashboard. Here, the AI proposes specific risk scores derived strictly from the document's content.

Crucially, the MVP enforces a "Human-in-the-Loop" validation workflow. The data is not applied to the database automatically. As visible in the UI, Lukas must actively review the AI Findings Overview and click "Confirm & Apply Scoring". This ensures that while AI does the heavy lifting, the final compliance decision remains with the human officer, a fundamental requirement for legal accountability.

10.3.3. The Compliance Command Center

The homescreen of the MVP is the Compliance Command Center, architected specifically around Cognitive Load Theory (Sweller, 1988). Research indicates that human working memory is strictly limited. When compliance officers are flooded with raw data streams from hundreds of suppliers, they face cognitive overload, leading to decision fatigue and critical oversight errors.

To prevent this, our dashboard aggregates complex data into a simplified, actionable view designed to minimize extraneous cognitive load.

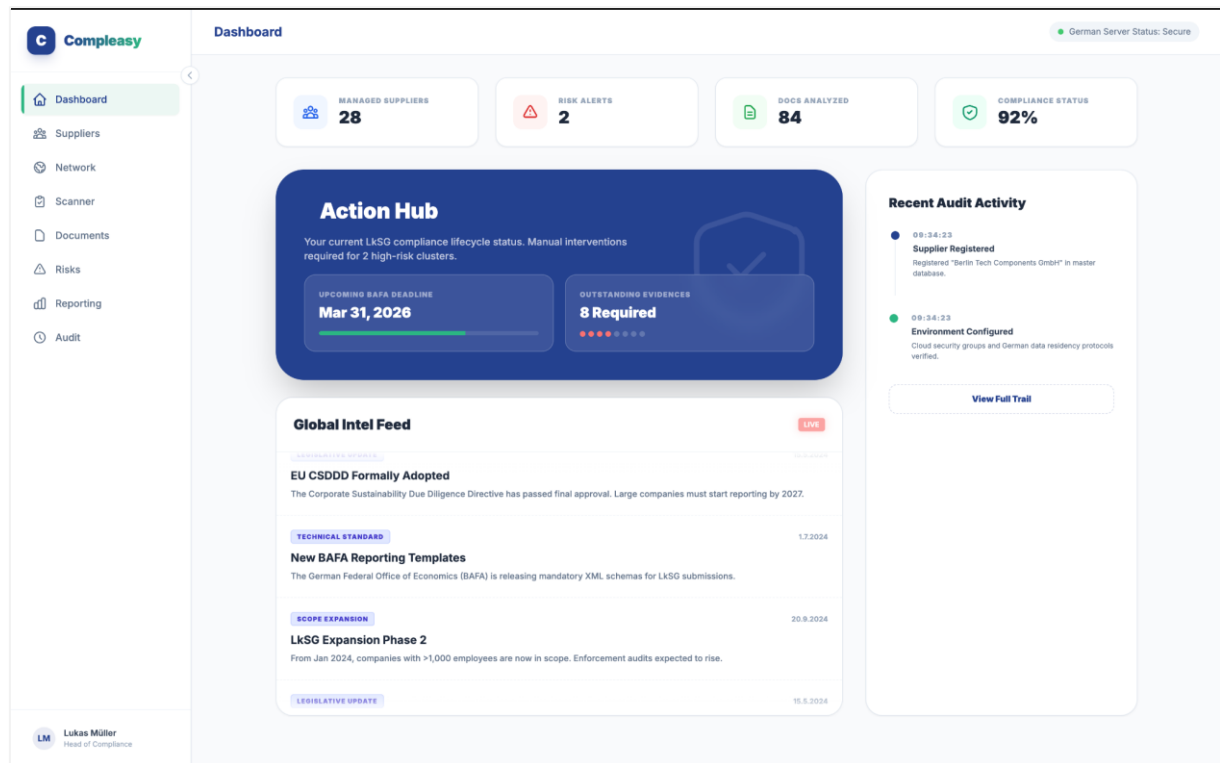


Figure 18 Client Dashboard

As seen in the dashboard view, Lukas Müller is presented with a curated "Morning Briefing" rather than raw database tables. The central Action Hub immediately directs his attention to the only signals that matter right now: the 2 active Risk Alerts and the approaching BAFA Deadline on March 31, 2026.

Instead of manually calculating his standing, the top-level KPIs provide instant situational awareness. Furthermore, the Global Intel Feed visible at the bottom automates regulatory monitoring, pushing critical updates directly to his workspace, eliminating the need for external research.

### 10.3.4. Reporting

The final output of the compliance process is the annual report to the government, often the most stressful deadline for officers like Lukas Müller. The MVP automates this burden with a generation engine. By injecting the structured supplier data and risk scores into a compliant template, the system creates a full report that adheres strictly to the formatting requirements of **§ 10 Section 2 of the LkSG** and aligns with the structure of the latest **BAFA reporting guidelines published in 2024**.

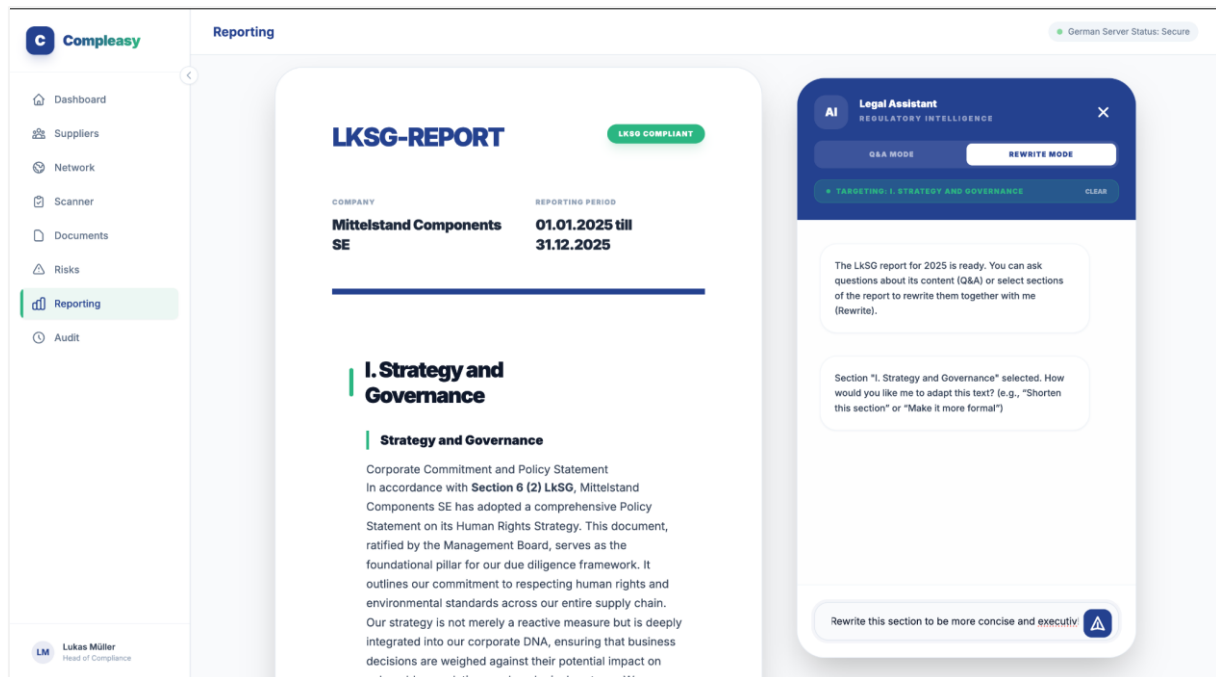


Figure 19 AI-Assisted Report Generation

However, because static reports rarely fit every stakeholder need perfectly, the MVP integrates a specialized **AI Agent** directly into the workspace. As shown in the screenshot, Lukas works with the agent in a split-screen view.

This agent is designed according to the latest "Agentic Workflow" paradigms, distinguishing between **Reasoning** and **Execution** phases (Yao et al., 2023):

1. **Q&A Mode (Reasoning):** This mode is fully grounded in a database containing the complete legal text of the LkSG. Lukas uses it to clarify specific regulatory ambiguities (e.g., "Does this supplier count as Tier 1 according to § 2?"), effectively replacing expensive external legal consultations during the planning phase.
2. **Rewrite Mode (Execution):** Here, the agent moves from advisor to actor. Lukas highlights specific sections of the generated text and instructs the AI to "make this more concise".

This distinction allows Lukas to maintain full control over the final output (Human-in-the-Loop) while leveraging the AI to execute the actual drafting work.

#### 10.4. Roadmap to Product-Market Fit and Diffusion

These features describe an Alpha release which helps us to close the gap between early adopters and the first majority of users. This concept is known as "Crossing the Chasm" (Moore, 1991). To move from MVP to a product, our roadmap focuses on integration and proactivity. In the next phase, we will build API connectors for major ERP systems like SAP and Microsoft Dynamics. This is crucial because it lowers the costs for customers, attracting

them to our ecosystem. To further lower barriers for the security-conscious German Mittelstand, we will also migrate our infrastructure from Azure to STACKIT, a certified German cloud provider, ensuring maximum data sovereignty.

Following that, we will move from “simple” analysis (reading supplier reports) to predictive risk monitoring. With real-time news feeds and sentiment analysis, the system will alert users of strikes, natural disasters, or political instability affecting their supply chain as early as possible.

This approach ensures we solve the current challenge of compliance reporting first, securing our position in the market before expanding our capabilities to become a fully integrated supply chain intelligence platform.

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## Appendix

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The Financing Model will be supplied as a separate email.